



MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE & HUNTER REGION LTD

THE CITY OF NEWCASTLE MEDAL 2005
AWARDED TO THE VOLUNTEERS OF THE MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE



"This award is made in recognition of the outstanding contributions to the support and empowerment of migrants to our city and for unfailing commitment to creating and sustaining multicultural harmony".

(City of Newcastle)

2005 Annual General Report

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-CONTENTS-

PAGE	ITEM
2	AGENDA
3	MRC MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE & STAFF & PROJECTS OF 2004-2005
4	MINUTES OF MRC 19TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING 2004
8	ATTENDANCE LIST OF MRC 19 TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING 2004
9	PURPOSES & OBJECTIVES OF MRC
10	SERVICE PRINCIPLES OF MRC
11	OVERVIEW OF MRC 2005
12	MRC REGIONS
13	CHAIRMAN'S REPORT
15	DIRECTOR'S REPORT
17	COMMUNITY PROJECT OFFICER
19	RURAL SUPPORT WORKER - CSSS
21	COMMUNITY SETTLEMENT SERVICES WORKER - WELFARE OUTREACH - CSSS
23	REFUGEE & HUMANITARIAN ENTRANT WORKER
25	SUDANESE & AFRICAN SUPPORT WORKER - CSSS
27	AFRICAN YOUTH WORKER - CSSS
29	NEW ENGLAND PROJECT WORKER - CSSS
31	VOLUNTEER RESOURCE WORKER
32	JOURNEYS FROM AFRICA – DESTINATION HUNTER 'LIVING IN HARMONY' PROJECT
34	AFRICAN FAMILY SUPPORT PROJECT – FAMILIES FIRST
36	MULTICULTURAL FAMILY SUPPORT PROJECT – FAMILIES FIRST
38	FILIPINO WELFARE PROJECT
40	MULTICULTURAL FAMILY SUPPORT WORKER
42	COMMUNITY AGED CARE PACKAGES
44	HUNTER MULTICULTURAL RESPITE SERVICE
46	MULTICULTURAL SOCIAL SUPPORT SERVICE – CENTRAL COAST
48	COMMUNITY VISITORS SCHEME
50	CALD TRANSPORT INDUCTION PROJECT
52	COMPUTER TRAINING FOR SENIORS
54	OTHER STAFF MEMBERS
55	CENTRE USAGE 2005
56	REFUGEE WEEK 2005 PHOTOS & AMBASSADOR QUOTES
61	AUDITORS REPORT CUTCHER & NEALE CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS pp.1-24

ANNUAL GENERAL REPORT 2005



MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE

OF NEWCASTLE & HUNTER REGION LIMITED

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NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN OF THE

20th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

OF THE

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE

TO BE HELD ON WEDNESDAY 30 NOVEMBER 2005

AT 8 CHAUCER STREET HAMILTON

AT 10.00AM

1. OPENING & WELCOME
BY CHAIRMAN, MR HENRY CHAN
2. APOLOGIES
3. MINUTES OF 2004 AGM
4. BUSINESS ARISING
5. PRESENTATION OF REPORTS
6. CONFIRMATION OF AUDITORS
7. ELECTION OF
MRC MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE
8. GENERAL BUSINESS
9. CLOSE & LIGHT REFRESHMENTS

GUEST SPEAKER: THE HON. MILTON ORKOPOULOS, MP

- ☐ Minister for Aboriginal Affairs
- ☐ Minister Assisting The Premier On Citizenship
- ☐ Member for Swansea

MRC MANAGEMENT COMMITTEE MEMBERS 2004-2005

Chairperson	- Mr Henry Chan
Vice Chairperson	- Mr William Simanowsky
Treasurer	- Mr Paul Mather / MsTrudy Mills Evers
Assistant Treasurer	- Rev. Father Nicholas Zervas
Secretary	- Ms Alina Kizeweter
Assistant Secretary	- Ms Sania Young
Member	- Mr Zoran Vasiljevic
Member	- Mr Ivan Klopac
Member	- Mr Andrea Rufo
Member	- Mr Phillip Ross

REPRESENTATIVE MEMBERS

Department of Immigration & Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs	- Mr Tim Morgan / Mr Ian Johns
Newcastle City Council	- Cr Barbara Gaudry

STAFF

Director	- Violetta Walsh
Assistant Director/Migration Agent	- Lulu Tantos
Financial Controller	- Arlene Richards
Migration Agent/ Community Project Officer/ Russian Welfare	- Irina Lupish
Office Manager	- Mary Milevski
Administrative Officers	- Sharna Duffy/Sinead Buckley
Community Development Worker CSSS Rural Support	- Alex Burns
Welfare Outreach Worker -CSSS	- Miza Torlakovic
Sudanese & African Communities Support Worker-CSSS	- Simon Pabek
African Youth Worker -CSSS	- Manyang Arob
African Family Support Worker (Families First)	- Iqbal Al-smadi
IHSS Refugee & Humanitarian Entrant Worker	- Tima Oto
Refugee Settlement Assistant (IHSS)	- Louise Gibson
Refugee Settlement Assistant (Visa 202)	- Roz Kapusta
Living In Harmony Project Officer	- Cathy Johnston
Hunter Multicultural Respite Service Coordinator/	
Refugee Employment Support Officer	- Christine Follett
Filipino Welfare Worker	- Petrona Kelly
Multicultural Family Support Worker (Families First)	- Devika Wijewardene
Community Visitors Scheme Coordinator	- Johanna Dupree
Community Aged Care Packages Coordinators	- Slavica Hristov/Lupe Fonua
Multicultural Social Support Service Coordinators	- Olivia Fuente/Dusan Marjanovic
Multicultural Social Support Administrator	- Sharlene Huber
CSSS New England Project Worker	- Kristin Teece/Patrick Prouheze/ Leesa Moore
Volunteer Resource Worker	- Pat Dring/Paul Sidebottom
E-Lodge Citizenship Support Officer	- Annie Gawn/Sinead Buckley

SESSIONAL STAFF

Pacific Islander Welfare Worker (Samoan)	- Juanita Loli
Pacific Islander Welfare Worker (Tongan)	- Teleisia Lolohea/Lupe Fonua
Thai Welfare Worker	- Nellie Srisurapon
Russian Welfare Worker	- Alla O'Regan
CALD Transport Project	- Carla Silva
Computer Training (IT) for Seniors / IT Consultant	- Daniel Follett
Skillmax Coordinator	- Kathy Patterson
Hunter Ethnic Parents & Teachers Association	
of Community Languages Project Officer	- Michael O'Sullivan/Kristine Horan

**MINUTES OF THE 19TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING OF
THE MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE & HUNTER REGION LIMITED,
HELD AT THE MRC PREMISES, ON WEDNESDAY 17 NOVEMBER 2004 AT 11.00AM**

PRESENT: As per list attached

1. Chairman H Chan observed one minutes silence in memory of fellow board member P Mather, who sadly passed away this morning. Henry acknowledged P Mather's contribution to the MRC. H Chan expressed his personal regard for P Mather as a good friend & respected colleague.
H Chan said all MRC committee & staff members are shocked & deeply saddened by the loss.

2. H Chan welcomed everyone present on behalf of the MRC Management Committee.

3. **APOLOGIES:** (none)

4. **MINUTES OF THE 2003 AGM:**

Proposed: Rev Fthr N Zervas

Seconded: I Klopac

5. **BUSINESS ARISING:**

- V Walsh reports Marcella Sutcliffe has now retired officially retired due to ill health. V Walsh added that Marcella's position at MRC is continuing & her role & responsibilities is shared amongst other staff.
- H Chan commented that refugee settlement in the local area is continuing & he welcomed all African & Sudanese families.
- H Chan mentioned the funding for New England has proved successful. (For further details see Staff Reports - Kris Teece)
- L Tantos acknowledged Simon Pabek as one of the newest refugee support workers continuously involved in helping the new & settling African & Sudanese families as part of the IHSS settlement process.

6. **PRESENTATION OF REPORTS**

- (i) **Chairperson's Report** – H Chan presented his report. It is his 14th year as Chairperson of the MRC Management Committee.
- (ii) **V Walsh – Director:** Report tabled & accepted as read.
- (iii) **I Lupish – Migration Agent/Russian Welfare/CPO:** Report tabled & accepted as read.
- (iv) **A Burns – Community Settlement Services Worker 1:** Report tabled & accepted as read.
- (v) **M Torlakovic – Community Settlement Services Worker 2:** Report tabled & accepted as read.

2005 ANNUAL GENERAL REPORT

(vi) **T Oto – Refugee & Humanitarian Entrant Worker:** Report tabled & accepted as read.

- T Oto expressed appreciation of the work of the volunteers particularly Robyn Graham & Ross Leonard.

(vii) **S Pabek – Sudanese & African Communities Support Worker:** Report tabled & accepted as read.

- S Pabek acknowledged the recently formed Sudanese Dance Group & commented on their recent performance for Austcare Refugee Week, as a positive & successful event.

(viii) **C Follett - Skilled Migrant Placement Officer:** Report tabled & accepted as read (absent).

- V Walsh added that C Follett is back working with MRC 2 days a week in a Refugee Employment Support capacity. V Walsh welcomed C Follett back to the MRC Staff team.

(ix) **C Johnston – Productive Diversity In The Workplace:** Report tabled & accepted as read.

- C Johnston thanked Staff for their continued support of the project. C Johnston also extended her thanks for efforts made in following up with the Department, following the decision to cease funding of the project.
- C Johnston thanked the Board & Staff & said she was very happy to return & head another worthwhile project (Living In Harmony).

(x) **P Kelly – Filipino Welfare Support Worker:** Report tabled & accepted as read.

(xi) **D Wijewardene – Multicultural Family Support (Families First) Worker:** Report tabled & accepted as read.

(xii) **Community Aged Care Packages - Sue Hristov & Teleisia Lolohea:** Report tabled & accepted as read.

- S Hristov reported that all packages were full & operating well.
- Currently 400 people are on waiting lists – have applied for more packages considering this demand.

(xiii) **A Dupree – Community Visitors Scheme:** Report tabled & accepted as read.

- A Burns spoke about insurance becoming an issue for volunteers involved in the program.
- Alex also mentioned the need for more volunteers.

(xiv) **T Oto & S Dwyer – Multicultural Family Support Worker:** Report tabled & accepted as read.

(xv) **K Teece – Community Settlement Services Scheme – New England Project:** Report tabled & accepted as read.

- A Burns reported, K Teece is currently on maternity leave, following birth of child. She returns to position in February 2005. Patrick Prouheze is maximising the position as locum until then. Alex will support & monitor the worker & services.

STAFF REPORTS ACCEPTED

Proposer: Z Vasiljevic
Seconded: S Young

7. FINANCIAL REPORTS: T Mills Evers (Assistant Treasurer) asked to present reports.

- T Mills Evers commented briefly on Paul Mathers sudden passing & added that he will be very missed. She then asked MRC Financial Controller Arlene Richards, to expand on financial reports.
- A Richards said that all MRC associated funds have now been transferred to the new banking institution, the Greater Building Society.
- H Chan concluded, the MRC is currently in a healthy financial state & the MRC Management Committee will strive to maintain this position.

8. APPOINTMENT OF COMPANY AUDITORS:

- Cutcher & Neale acknowledged for their continued good work.
- H Chan confirmed Cutcher & Neale be retained as the Centre's Auditor for 2005.

9. Election of the MRC Management.

1. **Mr Henry Chan**
2. **Mr William Simanowsky**
3. **Ms Trudy Mills-Evers**
4. **Ms Alina Kizeweter**
5. **Ms Sania Young**
6. **Mr Zoran Vasiljevic**
7. **Mr Andrea Rufo**
8. **Mr Father Nicholas Zervas**
9. **Mr Ivan Kloplic**

The 9 nominations were duly elected as the 2005 Management Committee.

10. GENERAL BUSINESS:

- (i) L Tantos reported of the recent CRC funded project for 2005 – a Homework Centre for the Sudanese.

- L Tantos expressed a general need for resources for newly arrived refugees.
L Tantos added, concerns arise daily – however the MRC can only act as they arise. More issues will need to be addressed in the future.

- (ii) A Burns mentioned considerations for a new worker to service the Gosford & Wyong LGA.

- (iii) W Simanowsky thanked fellow students of Seniors IT, for participating & experiencing the free computer training, held at the Centre & instructed by Dan Follett.
W Simanowsky commented, the course proved to be a success on many levels.

W Simanowsky also expressed thanks to Chairperson H Chan, his Management Committee colleagues & MRC Staff members for their support & assistance over the past year.

- (iv) Robert Lee Tolbert, a Liberian refugee expressed his thanks & appreciation towards the MRC & the effort of all staff.

11. Guest Speaker:

MR JIM O' CALLAGHAN

State Director

Department of Immigration & Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs

MEETING CLOSED AT 11.40AM

NEXT ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING TO BE HELD ON
WEDNESDAY 30 NOVEMBER 2005 AT 11.00AM



MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE OF THE MRC ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING HELD ON 17 NOVEMBER 2004		
	Name	Community/ Organisation
1.	Zivko Micevski	Macedonian Pensioners
2.	William Simanowsky	Board/Ukrainian Community
3.	Isaac Davis	Liberian Community
4.	Michael O'Sullivan	HPTACLS/MRC Staff
5.	Irina Lupish	MRC Staff Member
6.	Lulu Tantos	MRC Staff Member
7.	Miza Torlakovic	MRC Staff Member
8.	Mary Milevski	MRC Staff Member
9.	Trudy Mills Evers	MRC Management Committee
10.	Henry Chan	Chairman MRC Management Committee/Chinese Community
11.	Tima Oto	MRC Staff Member/ Tongan Community
12.	Cathy Johnston	MRC Staff Member
13.	Denise Hodgson	Centrelink MSO
14.	Simon Pabek	MRC Staff Member
15.	Violetta Walsh	MRC Director
16.	Pet MC Kelly	MRC Staff Member
17.	Annie Gawn	MRC Staff Member
18.	Luigi Adllan	Sudanese Community
19.	Michael Ngama	Sudanese Community
20.	Adam Lepidis	Greek Macedonian Brotherhood Pavlos-Melas
21.	Amer Meshack	Sudanese Community
22.	Saninu Mayou	Sudanese Community
23.	Susana Manyiel	Sudanese Community
24.	Alex Burns	MRC Staff Member
25.	Robyn Graham	MRC Volunteer Staff Member
26.	Grace Dennis	Liberian Community
27.	Juanita Loli	MRC Staff Member
28.	Esther Cole	Liberian Community
29.	Garmann Dennis	Liberian Community
30.	Butheian Kaka	Liberian Community
31.	Devika Wijewardene	MRC Staff Member
32.	Charles Bak	MRC Staff Member/Sudanese Community
33.	Arlene Richards	MRC Staff Member
34.	Alina Kizeweter	MRC Management Committee/Polish Community
35.	Fr. Nicholas Zervas	MRC Management Committee/Greek Community
36.	Ivan Klopac	MRC Management Committee/Slovenian Community
37.	Robert Lee Tolbert	Liberian Community
38.	Baikisu Tolbert	Liberian Community
39.	Sue Hristov	MRC Staff Member/ CACP
40.	Victor Lupish	Russian Community/HECS
41.	Pat Dring	MRC Member
42.	Sania Young	MRC Management Committee/Russian Community
43.	Zoran Vasiljevic	MRC Management Committee/Bosnian Community
44.	Ann Dupree	MRC Staff Member/ Dutch Society



MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE & HUNTER REGION LIMITED

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PURPOSE

- The MRC of Newcastle and Hunter Region Ltd is a community based not for profit organization, which has operated in the Newcastle area since its establishment by the Federal Government in 1981.
- The MRC's mission is to strive for the successful integration of migrants in the Hunter and outreach locations identified by the Rural Strategy of the Department of Immigration and Multicultural Affairs', being the North, North West, Central West and Central Coast of NSW.

OBJECTIVES

- To deliver high quality settlement services to target group
- To focus on service delivery for special needs groups – refugee/humanitarian entrants, newly arrived, unemployed, aged, young people and women.
- To promote an environment of mutual understanding between the mainstream and ethnic communities.
- To provide outreach services to people of non-English Speaking Background residing in isolated and rural areas.

Service Principles

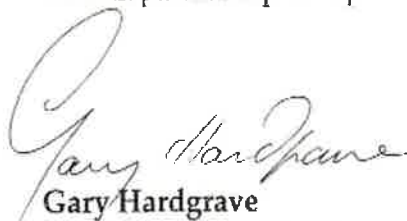
The Hon Gary Hardgrave MP, Minister for Citizenship and Multicultural Affairs, is committed to ensuring that Migrant Resource Centres/Migrant Service Agencies provide the highest quality service, and maintain a focus on client needs.

This is supported by the *Newcastle and Hunter Region Migrant Resource Centre*.

The Minister and the *Newcastle and Hunter Region Migrant Resource Centre* endorse the following principles, which must guide the provision of quality programs and services:

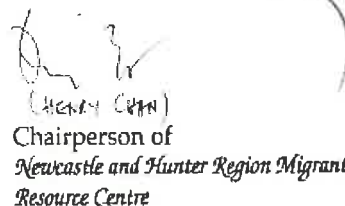
1. Newly arrived migrants must have equal opportunity to realise their full potential and must have access to appropriate programs and services;
2. Every person should be able to maintain his or her culture without prejudice or disadvantage and should be encouraged to understand and embrace other cultures;
3. Needs of migrants should, in general, be met by programs and services available to the whole community but special services and programs may be necessary to ensure equality of access and provision; and
4. Services and programs should be designed and operated in full consultation with clients, and self-help should be encouraged as much as possible with a view to helping migrants to become self-reliant quickly.

The Minister and *Newcastle and Hunter Region Migrant Resource Centre* will work in partnership to implement this commitment.



Gary Hardgrave
Minister for Citizenship and
Multicultural Affairs

Date: 01/06/2002



(HENRY CHEN)
Chairperson of
*Newcastle and Hunter Region Migrant
Resource Centre*

Date: 06/06/2002

Overview of 2005

MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE & HUNTER REGION LIMITED

Funded Partnerships throughout 2005

Department of Immigration & Multicultural and Indigenous Affairs
 NSW Department of Community Services
 Commonwealth Department of Health and Ageing
 Community Relations Commission for a Multicultural NSW
 NSW Department of Ageing, Disability and Home Care
 Ministry of Transport
 Department of Urban Affairs and Planning - Area Assistance Scheme
 Federal Attorney General's Department
 Newcastle City Council

Clients by Ethnic Background

Albania	Egypt	Lithuania	Samoa
Algeria	Fiji	Malaysia	Scotland
Australia	Finland	Macedonia	Serbia
Austria	France	Mexico	Sierra Leone
Argentina	Germany	Montenegro	Singapore
Azerbaijan	Greece	Morocco	Slovenia
Bangladesh	Honduras	Mauritius	South Africa
Botswana	Hong Kong	Netherlands	Spain
Bosnia	Hungary	Nepal	Sri Lanka
Brazil	India	New Zealand	Sudan
Burundi	Indonesia	Nigeria	Sweden
Canada	Ireland	Norway	Switzerland
Chile	Iran	Panama	Syria
China	Iraq	Pakistan	Tahiti
Colombia	Italy	Papua New Guinea	Taiwan
Congo (Rep. of)	Japan	Paraguay	Thailand
Costa Rica	Jordan	Persia	Tonga
Croatia	Kazakhstan	Peru	Tunisia
Cyprus	Kenya	Poland	Turkey
Czech Republic	Korea	Portugal	Ukraine
Dominican Republic	Kuwait	Philippines	Uruguay
East Timor	Latvia	Rwanda	USA
England	Lebanon	Romania	Venezuela
El Salvador	Liberia	Russia	Vietnam



MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE & HUNTER REGION LIMITED

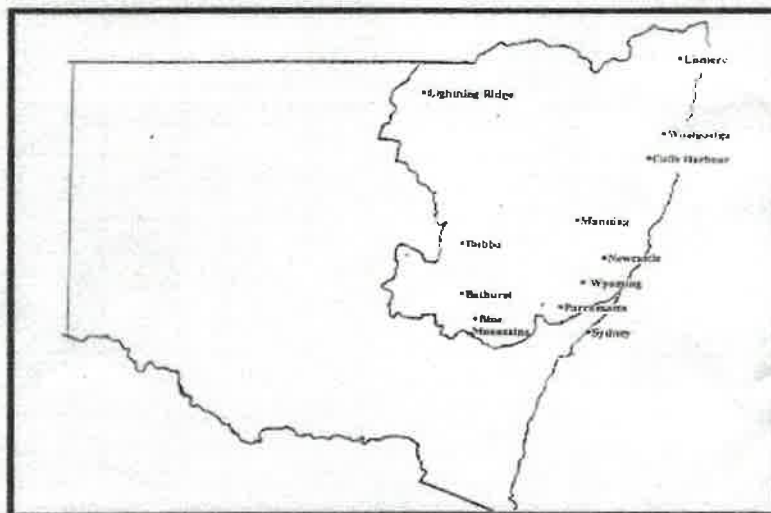
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OUR REGIONS

HUNTER AREA



RURAL STRATEGY AREA



Chairman's Report Henry Chan



This is a milestone year for the MRC of Newcastle and the Hunter, marking on the one hand, the end of an era, and at the same time and most assuredly, the beginning of a new chapter in the life and times of our resilient and productive organisation.

The Department of Immigration Multicultural and Indigenous Affairs has moved to a changed approach to funding the settlement services hitherto provided by Migrant Resource Centres. It will no longer allocate "core" funding but will invite tenders from interested parties to carry out this important work. These changes were signaled in the Report of the Review of Settlement Services, which took place in 2003 with its variety of recommendations, which are now being implemented.

We have been preparing for this new tendering process, and have strategies in place to deal with the changes, but of course cannot help but feel a degree of uncertainty as we embark on a competitive environment in the delivery of settlement services in our Region.

Of course this is not a new experience in this sector, for agencies like this. Uncertainty has been our constant companion for as long as I have been Chairman –which is a very long time indeed.

And tendering is clearly becoming the preferred way for government to outsource human services, even those that were once part of their own core business. It is competition policy and whether we like it or not, it is here to stay.

We should, in theory, have nothing to fear, if tenders are won on the basis of true merit assessed on reputation and track record, expertise and experience, knowledge and networks, and of course value for money. Unfortunately we know that is not always the case, as we saw in the recent allocation of the Integrated Humanitarian Settlement Strategy (IHSS) tender for the entire Sydney-Hunter-Illawarra areas to a profit making concern with no credentials in this Region, and seemingly little settlement experience of any kind anywhere.

There are many heads here still shaking in disbelief that the collaborative and effective IHSS service provided by the Centre to the Hunter's very newly arrived refugees could so easily be discarded, and widespread concern continues about the new provider's ability to carry out this important and sensitive work in the way these vulnerable people need.

But we must remain optimistic about this new bidding era upon us, and we are putting forward the best submissions possible to DIMIA's Combined Settlement Grants Program. It is gratifying that we have the strong support of many local organizations, who share our values and who we hope will partner us in the delivery of even better and more comprehensive settlement services to our refugees and migrants.

And it is hard not to be optimistic. There have been so many wonderful highlights in the year that continues to make me very proud to be associated with the Centre, and two are standouts.

In September this year, the Volunteers of the Migrant Resource Centre were awarded the City of Newcastle Medal for their extraordinary contribution to multiculturalism and community harmony in our city. It is a wonderful recognition of the dozens of "unsung" heroes who are associated with this Centre—an eclectic diverse group, from all walks of life and from a range of ethnic backgrounds.

They comprise the volunteers who have sustained us in our refugee work, who have supported us in our care of the aged, and, yes, those of us who have served on the Board of this Centre.

It was indeed a proud moment.

And earlier in March our Director, Violetta Walsh, was awarded the inaugural Harmony Day Honours, to add another "gong" to her already impressive collection.

A fine leader, for a fine team of staff.

Finally I want to take the opportunity to thank my fellow directors for their hard work and dedication throughout the year. I have one, very deep sadness, one which I know is shared by everyone at this Centre, and that is the sudden untimely death of our Treasurer, Paul Mather, on the morning of our AGM last year. He was a truly engaging individual who gave so much to the Centre, and I know we miss him still.

Henry Chan

Director's Report Violetta Walsh



This last year has been a particularly busy and challenging one for the MRC, beginning with a very dramatic and high profile event, which had a very significant effect on our community, and continues in many ways to impact on our work in this region.

I refer to the anti refugee rally of the 22nd January which was arranged by a group calling themselves the Concerned Citizens Collective, a group purportedly "concerned with the changing face of Newcastle and its surrounding suburbs due to the forced immigration of so-called Sudanese refugees." This was the content of their letter drop around various city suburbs, but it did not quite have the effect they were after.

In fact, an amazing counter rally was organised in the space of just 2 days by a group of passionate refugee supporters from a great many organisations and from many walks of life. It was a magnificent exercise of collaboration and it really made me proud to be part of this community.

On the day of the racist rally close to 1000 Novocastrians assembled across the city to show their embrace of the refugees in their midst. A truly euphoric occasion when, for once, the "goodies" won, and the racists were routed.

Of course this was all played out in the public arena, and media interest was quite intense, but I am pleased to say very positive. And the Centre's key role in supporting refugees in the Hunter was highlighted at that time in an unprecedented way, and has indirectly led to a heightened response in the course of the year by local, state, and federal governments to meeting the needs of the new arrivals.

Newcastle City Council has pitched in with a grant to support cultural expression by funding the raw materials for dance costumes, which we know will enliven our various community events in the years to come. Community members themselves will be engaged in their production.

I must also note the excellent support we receive from the City Council in our various initiatives, such as Harmony Day which in 2005 was a day to remember, with the launch of our wonderful African Ambassadors who are doing more for building positive community relationship than anyone else I can think of.

The State government has also been responsive to our submissions to help meet the needs of refugee in the face of the limitations of existing infrastructure and unprecedented demand.

Department of Urban Affairs and Planning's Area Assistance Scheme has funded us to create a living skills DVD for African refugees, and we look forward to collaborating with the University of Newcastle to produce a much needed resource to understand their new world.

DOCS has responded to the needs of the refugee families, by making a grant available for a year to support some of the sole mothers with young children and to train a group of Home Start volunteers to provide that invaluable home based support and guidance. We will be advocating for more of the same once this pilot is completed.

The Community Relations Commission has been most generous in its support by providing us with funding to operate 2 Homework Centres in the Catholic School system for some of the refugee students who are really finding adjustment hard.

Federal departments have also come on board. DIMIA for example has funded an African Youth worker for 3 years, who we trust will make a major difference to the quality of life of these young people from East, Central and West Africa, and the Federal Attorney General's Department has recently awarded us funding for 18 months to carry out a project which we have entitled "New Land New Laws " whose purpose needs little explanation.

While our work with refugees has been most publicised, it is not our only service focus, and we are pleased to report the expansion of our very important services to the aged. Earlier this year we were approached by DADHC to auspice the Hunter NESB Dementia Respite Service, much needed and much welcome in this area, which will grow in response to rising demand.

Outreach work is another important part of our service output. As you would be aware our geographic footprint extends well beyond the Hunter. We are pleased to report that our DIMIA funded New England service is now fully operational, and with increasing African settlement in the centres of Tamworth, Armidale and Inverell, will become busier and busier.

On the Central Coast, the Multicultural Social Support Service, another DADHC funded service is beginning to make quite an impact on the lives of frail aged migrants and their Carers, -as we expected in an area whose older migrants have long been overlooked.

So all in all, the Centre continues as busy, as dynamic and as productive as always.

The loss of the Lower Hunter IHSS contract to a Sydney based consortium in the last tender - and please note DIMIA determined that the Hunter Region could not apply in its own right to carry out services in its own patch -is disappointing, but our hands are full as we continue to deliver our wide range of services to the over 600 refugees already settled here, and the thousands of migrants who have also settled in the areas we cover, and require a helping hand in their integration.

The end of 2005 brings a new chapter in the life of our agency. DIMIA has moved from allocating core funding to MRCs and is now calling for tenders for the delivery of settlement services. This seems to us a real opportunity to submit our ideas for creative and worthwhile settlement projects, in partnership with some very successful and compatible local agencies, who share our goals. Outcomes will not be known till next year, but I am fully optimistic that this Centre has a bright and shiny future in this great Region of ours.

Thank you to the MRC team, Board members and staff alike who make this Centre such a special place.

Violetta Walsh

Community Project Officer

Funded by Department of Immigration & Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs

Irina Lupish



As in previous years I have been extremely busy, providing Immigration Advice, assisting Russian speaking clients and as a CPO working with and supporting various government and non-governments services.

SERVICE DELIVERY - IMMIGRATION INFORMATION & ADVICE SERVICE

Our clients come from different parts of the world – See **Chart 1**. We have seen 658 clients and 1,109 telephone consultations, which are shown on **Chart 2**. **Chart 3** -

Clients come from **70** different backgrounds with the top 8 being: Philippines, Sudanese, Thai, Chinese, English, Russian, Macedonian, Zimbabwean.

Chart 1 - Clients come from different parts of the world

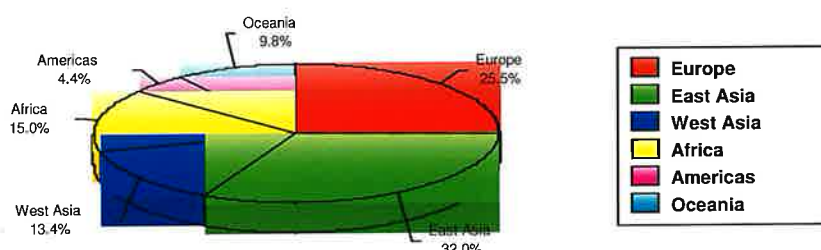


Chart 2 - Provision of service to clients by Migration Agents at the MRC

Agent	No of consultations	No telephone advice
L.Tantos	289	351
I.Lupish	369	758
Total	658	1,109

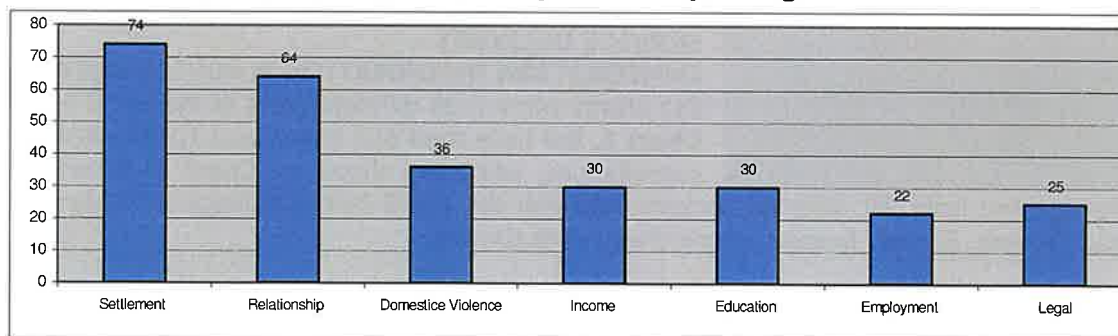
Chart 3 - Clients come from 70 different backgrounds with the top 8 being:

Origin	Occasion of Service	%
Philippines	59	9%
Sudanese	48	7.3%
Thai	46	7%
Chinese	45	6.8%
English	34	5%
Russian	29	4.4%
Macedonian	25	3.7%
Zimbabwean	18	2.7%

WELFARE SERVICE FOR THE RUSSIAN SPEAKING COMMUNITY

It was wonderful to have Alla O'Regan joining us in April this year. Together we have achieved much during this year. Apart from addressing **579** issues presented to us by clients, Alla has published **3** information Bulletins, updated MRC pamphlet, produced a service pamphlet for Russian speakers, updated data base of the community and we both assisted a TAFE student in preparing profile of the Russian Community in the Hunter and identified their needs. In addition **5** information sessions were organised.

Chart 4 – Seven top issues presented by Russian speaking clients.



COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT WORK

Outreach Work – consultation to individual clients and provision of information sessions were conducted in rural areas – in Dubbo, Orange, Bathurst, Lightning Ridge, Wauchope, Grafton and Lismore. **358** telephone contacts were made with clients and workers in rural and regional areas, covering our target regions.

Other community work – was organised, including two Refugee Week celebrations, in Singleton and Newcastle. Both were very successful and enjoyed by many. **72** people attended Singleton event and over **400** people attended Newcastle event & BBQ on the Foreshore. I would like to thank the volunteers, members of organizing committee and MRC staff who helped on these two celebrations.

I was very much involved in organising Domestic Violence Forum – “Domestic Violence in Diverse Community”. Over **100** people attended, with many interesting guest speakers, including the Department of Immigration, representative of Muslim Women Association of Sydney, our own Sudanese speaker, Violence Against Women co-ordinator, ACON representatives. We were entertained by members of local a theatre group and our own SPICE dancers.

During the year I have attended **72** meetings, apart from sessions mentioned above. I have presented **4** information sessions to TAFE students, one to the Youth Group at Multicultural Neighborhood Centre and one at the Domestic Violence Forum, I have supervised a 3rd year TAFE student and facilitated Newcastle Multicultural Interagency and Hunter Refugee Support Network.

Overall, it has been a very productive and rewarding year.

I would like to thank my colleagues and the Management Committee for their support during 2005.

Irina Lupish
Community Project Officer
Migration Agent
Russian Welfare Worker

Lulu Tantos
Deputy Director
Migration Agent

Alla O'Regan
Russian Welfare Worker

Rural Support Worker Community Settlement Services Scheme

Funded by Department of Immigration & Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs
Alex Burns

RURAL SUPPORT FOR CSSS PROJECTS

The main focus of this project has been to work closely, resourcing and mentoring the Department of Immigration's (DIMIA) Rural based CSSS projects in northern and western NSW. As in previous years a number of new CSSS projects came into being both locally in Newcastle and at Coffs Harbour. Several projects had changes with staff, caused mainly through illness, although severe management issues with one project led to the project going into abeyance for the time being. Generally the project staff remained as before, a committed and caring group of people. The major changes were those of increasing numbers of Humanitarian Entrants in rural areas, especially Sudanese, and a growing need to support dependants of Skilled Migrants.

Particular attention was given to the newer projects and to those where changes in staff meant that a new person had to face the challenges of being the only migrant worker in their locality.

Table 1 shows the frequency of this work through face-to-face contact, although this does not include the shared "Rural Conference" which took place in May. While the table indicates a high contact rate with a small number of projects, this is more a reflection of changes in staff and nearness of the project to the rural support project's home base.

Table 1: Face-to-Face Visits to each Rural Based CSSS Project in 2003-2004

Project	Visits
Manning Valley	8
Coffs Harbour	5
Coffs Harbour St Vincent De Paul	1
Woolgoolga	4
Lismore	3
Hunter Outreach	13
Wyoming	11
Bathurst	4
Dubbo	4
Lightning Ridge	2
Orange	4
New England	12
Afro-Sudanese	4
African Youth	3
Total	78

Work with the New England project was again higher than with other regional projects, as the project experienced a number of staff changes and the Rural Support project also represents the MRC on the New England projects Advisory Committee. The success of this project, is described elsewhere in this Report, mirrors the support given and the increasing challenges with secondary settlement of African refugees in the area covered by the project.

During the year five projects, including the Rural Support project, were given additional funding to address the needs of the dependants of Skilled migrants with low English Language proficiency. The role of the Rural Support project in relation to this new service development was to assist in developing strategies to address this group.

INTEGRATED SERVICE PLANNING

One of the considerable outcomes of this project has been its work in raising issues that affect the provision of settlement services in rural areas of northern NSW. This has meant that the project has had input into policy development and planning through work with a range of government and non-government services.

Table 2 outlines organisations with which planning and development work has taken place. Many of the issues raised were the outcomes of the work of seven Multicultural Interagencies/Networks. The Rural Support Project has been very influential with these, convening, chairing or acting as the secretary to these and participation in these is shown in **Table 3**. A paper on the Networks/Interagencies was given to the Cultural Diversity in Health Conference.

Table 2: Planning and Development Work with other agencies

Name	Consultations	Name	Consultations
DIMIA	5	DADHC	5
DoCS –state	2	DoCS – regional	3
AMES	1	Hunter Disaster Welfare	2
Health	3	Centrelink	1
Hunter Water	2	Trans Cultural Mental Health Rural Project	2
NSW Department of Education – TAFE	3	ECC of NSW	2
NAATI	3	STARTTS	1
Singleton Council	2	Upper Hunter Council	1
Port Stephens Council	2	RYDON	2
MDAA	1	Newcastle Council	3
Bathurst Council	1	Hunter Community Council	1
Ethnic Aged Services (Hunter)	2	Hunter CALD Disability Network	4

Table 3: Participation in Multicultural Interagencies or Networks

Network	Number	Network	Number
Mid-North Coast Multicultural Network	3	Central Coast Multicultural Network	5
North Coast Multicultural Network	4	Hunter Rural Multicultural Network	9
Newcastle Multicultural Interagency	4	Central –Orana Far West Multicultural Interagency	2
New England Multicultural Interagency	3	Hunter Refugee Network	3
Hunter CALD Disability Network	4	Central Coast Disability Network	2

A number of Cultural Awareness Competency sessions was given in the Hunter and across the northern area of the State including at Lightning Ridge, Forster, Taree, Port Macquarie, Gosford, as well as in Newcastle.

As in previous years the Rural Support Project assisted the MRC with general support to other MRC projects and in particular to its Outreach services.

Alex Burns

Community Settlement Services Worker-Welfare Outreach Community Settlement Services Scheme

Funded by Department of Immigration, Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs
Miza Torlakovic

This project provides casework information and referral to new arrived migrants, humanitarian entrants and family migrants in Newcastle and five outreach locations in the Hunter Valley.

Table1 below shows that casework services were provided to **460** clients of **34** different backgrounds (countries of birth) from the MRC and the five Outreach locations (Charlestown, Salamander Bay, Cessnock, Singleton & Raymond Terrace).

Table 1: Numbers of different countries represented by clients

CLIENT CHARACTERISTICS												
Numbers of different Countries represented by Clients	Sex		Years in Australia			Age				Clients		Total Number of Clients
	F E M A L E	M A L E	<2 yrs	2-5 yrs	5+ yrs	0<16 yrs	16<25 yrs	25<55 yrs	55+ yrs	Humanitarian Entrant	First Time Client	
34	289	181	72	141	247	13	46	292	109	261	198	460

A majority of the client group were women, 62 % of the total client group.

The greatest numbers of clients were those aged between 25 and 55 years, 64 %.

Humanitarian entrants were significant recipients, 57 %.

213 clients have lived in Australia for less than five years, which is 46% of the total.

Table 1 also shows that **198** clients, or 43%, were first time clients.

Furthermore, **1241** telephone services were provided by the project.

OUTREACH

Currently there are **5** different venues around Hunter where a face-to-face outreach service has been and continues to be provided. Apart from the library, as the new venue for my outreach in Singleton, I have also started a new outreach in Charlestown servicing southern Lake Macquarie and this take place every Monday however it is still developing. Port Stephens has two outreach venues, Salamander Bay and Raymond Terrace, every alternate Thursday. More time has been spent in Singleton than in the other location, Cessnock, due to many new arrivals.

GROUP WORK

This year **26** Information sessions were organized as support to specific groups of clients and these include: 5 Health sessions, 7 Settlement information, 3 Income Support, 2 legal, 2 Education, 1 Learning English, and 3 others which include transport and social development. These were held in Newcastle, Singleton, Edgeworth and Muswellbrook. **440** people attended these sessions.

This year **32** new arrivals, mainly humanitarian entrants settled at Singleton and many sessions were organized for this particular group. However, all the other groups in the outreach locations have had great information needs such as the new Thai and Japanese groups. The longer settled and isolated migrants also required information sessions with continual updates of information on service providers, particularly where changes in Government legislation have occurred.

This year a new Multicultural Friendship group was established in partnership with the Muswellbrook Community Health Social Worker and with great support from Centrelink MSO. The group is now meeting regularly on monthly basis at the Muswellbrook Community Health.

OTHER WORK

130 people attended **3** Multicultural Information Services Expos presented this last 12 months. These were organised by the Hunter Rural Multicultural Workers Network with my self as convener and they were held in Scone, Maitland and Raymond Terrace.

The launch of new Homework Centre in Singleton took place on 28 October, again due to the need of many new arrivals and humanitarian entrants. This mainly helped children from Iraq but other migrant children also have benefited. This was an additional initiative of the outreach project.

The first Refugee week Celebration ever held in Singleton took place this year with over **70** people attending. This celebration arose in response to the growing number of refugees settling in Singleton and to encourage their participation in the Singleton community.

While participating in developing an ideas for the Social Plan for the Upper Hunter Council for CALD residents living at Scone. The 3 Social Planners from Merriwa, Scone and Murrurundi were approached and have supported the establishment of information Hubs in these locations. These will provide information on services for migrants.

During this year I attended 2 Singleton, 1 Scone, 1 Cessnock, 3 Port Stephens and 1 Muswellbrook Interagencies. Involved in developing Social Plan for Singleton and Upper Hunter Councils. I also attended 3 Centrelink forums and 2 DoCS CALD Regional Advisory Committee.

Miza Torlakovic

Refugee & Humanitarian Entrant Worker

Funded by Department of Immigration & Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs

Tima 'Oto



My report covers the period from January – August 2005 of visa 200 arrivals. I have been assisting refugee new arrivals predominantly Africans with their settlement needs. So far it has been very interesting, challenging as well as being very demanding. My work has involved settling refugee arrivals for up to 3 months, then reassigning them to the African CSSS worker or maintaining them as casework.

Tables 1 and 2 provide a range of information on the new refugees. These are outlined below and as can be seen the number of arrivals settled in this period was **147** individuals with the largest numbers originating from Burundi.

ACHIEVEMENTS

Table 1: Shows the Pattern of Refugees arriving in the Hunter in 2005 from Africa & surrounds

Successful Settlement of over 35 families in the Newcastle area from January-August 2005			Age Group				Education Primary, Secondary, University, Tafe, Private, Government schools					Employed Fulltime, Part time		New Births	Total
			0-4	5-14	15-24	25+	Prim	Sec	Tafe & Uni	Priv	Gov	F/T	P/T		
	M	F													
Jan	11	7	4	8	5	1	5	0	4	0	5	1	0	1	18
Feb	4	2	1	2	2	1	1	2	1	0	5	0	0	0	6
Mar	8	7	4	4	4	3	5	1	3	0	6	0	0	0+1	15
Apr	14	13	4	10	7	6	7	5	7	0	8	3	0	0	27
May	1	3	0	2	1	1	1	2	1	0	3	0	0	0	4
Jun	1	4	2	0	0	3	0	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	5
Jul	10	10	3	8	4	5	6	6	3	0	12	0	0	0	20
Aug	29	23	11	15	9	17	10	0	19	5	8	0	0	1+1	52
Sep	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total	78	69	29	49	32	37	35	17	44	11	45	4	0	2	147

- 2 babies born and 2 babies on the way.
- 1 family of 10 moved to Sydney and 1 family of 4 moved to Melbourne. They have close family ties in Sydney and Melbourne and requested to move after 4-6 weeks of settlement.

TABLE 2: Country of Origin of the Refugee Arrivals

Country	Afghan	Liberia	Burundi	Sudan	Sierra Leone	Rwanda	The Republic of Congo	Iraq	Total
	4	41	52	35	4	3	4	4	147
Language Spoken	Farsi/Afghan	English French Mandingo Arabic African	Swahili Kiswahili Kirundi African	Arabic English	English Mandingo	English Kiswahili	Kiswahili Swahili	Arabic	

SERVICES PROVIDED

- Meet new arrivals at the Newcastle airport and transport them to temporary accommodation.
- Liaise with Centrelink – booking appointments and completing forms for benefit payments.
- Tax File Numbers Application – electronically
- Organising the opening of personal accounts with banks
- Liaising with Department of Housing for bond and advance rent. Completing application forms for the above.
- Searching for the appropriate rental properties.
- Assisting with connecting of phones, water, gas and electricity.
- Grocery for new arrivals and also making sure that there is an on arrival meal for new arrivals. Shopping for essential items, food, clothing and furniture.
- Liaising with SVDP Sydney for their Household Formation Package and also with the Suppliers re time and date of delivery.
- Referring clients to STARTTS (Service for the Treatment and Rehabilitation of Torture and Trauma Survivors) to assist with counseling and early intervention programmes.
- Organising doctor's appointment for initial health assessments and liaising with Migrant Health unit and Kaleidoscope for Initial Health checks.
- Organising with Medicare Office the issuing of Medicare cards.
- Organising the enrolment of the refugee children with the state and catholic schools.
- Making initial appointments for language assessment with the Adult Migrant English Program (AMEP)
- Providing transport to clients to and from appointments

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT/EVENTS/INFORMATION SESSIONS/MEETINGS

- In cooperation and partnership with some agencies and MRC staff I have organized and participated in information sessions and community outings in the past 8 months:
- Living Skills with Centrelink, Australian Taxation and Department of Housing
- Centrelink information session re Income and estimation for taxation purposes.
- Hunter Refugee Network Meetings
- Interdenominational Refugee Support meeting.

PROBLEMS/EMERGING ISSUES

- Liaising weekly with Real Estates – re problems with clients upkeep of properties and overdue rental payments
- Increasing number of new arrivals and total size of families/number of children
- Transport issues – driving with no drivers license and access to cars – MRC needs "people mover" to help solve these problems
- Significant Cultural differences
- Because of limited range of employment opportunities due lack of understanding of the Australian workplace culture and language.
- New refugees need more than the 3 months of assistance as per agreement period

HAND OVER OF CLIENTS TO NEW SETTLEMENT PROVIDER - ACL

- On the 30th September through Settlement Services International (SSI) we have handed over 17 families totaling 76 people to ACL for ongoing welfare support. These families arrived as from July to August. Even though these have been transferred many have been coming back to the Centre and we have continued to assist these families with settlement needs.

TAX HELP

- 100 clients were assisted with their tax returns

Tima 'Oto

Sudanese & African Communities Support Worker Community Settlement Services Scheme

Funded by Department of Immigration & Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs

Simon Majur Pabek



This project offers referral & casework information to refugees and special humanitarian entrants in the Newcastle & Lower Hunter Region. During this year this project has worked with more than **537** clients & **30** groups.

Table 1:
Client Contacts Services from October 8 2004 to November 4 2005

CLIENT CHARACTERISTICS													
ISSUES addressed with Clients on each contact	SERVICE TYPE		No. Of Comp I	SEX		YEARS IN AUSTRALIA			AGE				HUMAN- ITARIAN ENTRANT
	FtF	Tel		M	F	Under 2Yrs	2-5 Yrs	5+ Yrs	0<16 Yrs	16<25 Yrs	25<55 Yrs	55+ Yrs	
Immigration Info	102	51	19	83	70	115	18	4	7	62	81	3	137
Income Support & Finances	153	76	21	117	112	139	32		33	77	119	2	171
Material Assistance/ Emergency Relief	21	6	3	15	12	17	3		2	9	16		19
Employment	144	64	17	141	67	133	15	9	5	105	98		157
Education & Train.	37	20	5	33	24	49	5		13	27	17		54
Learning English	58	30	11	39	49	69	6	3	14	34	40		78
Accommodation & Housing	102	53	19	79	76	119	9	2	24	48	83		130
Health	85	37	9	56	66	91	9	3	30	44	48	2	103
Mental Health	3	5	2	5	3	4				2	6		2
Torture / trauma	24	17	3	19	22	26	5		5	16	21	1	31
Childcare	38	27	7	27	38	49	4	2	34	12	19		53
Youth Issues	72	34	14	76	30	87	5	2	36	54	16		94
Domestic Violence	7	13	2	9	11	7				11	9		7
Legal	5	2	2	3	4	6				2	5		6
Police	22	22	9	21	23	17	2		4	18	22		19
Settlement Info	174	71	22	135	110	188	19	9	32	91	122	4	216
O/S Documents	1			1		1					1		1
Filling Forms	102	11	16	45	68	99	12	2	18	41	54		113
Explaining letters	104	16	14	55	65	86	12	4	21	56	36		104
Total Number	1254	555		959	850	1302	156	40	278	709	813	12	1495
Grand Total	1809			1809									

In the period of 12 months, the African Communities worker provided **1809** occasions of services to **537** people, **1254** occasions were delivered face to face & **555** occasions of service were delivered to clients by telephone services.

Table 1 shows the nature of the services provided with general settlement information being the main service issue, **245** instances or 14%, of all cases. Income support and finances followed, **229** instances, then Employment **208** & accommodation **155**. Most services were given to people aged 25 to 55 years (**813**), with young people were provided with **709** cases of support and **278** for those aged 0 to 16 years.

2005 ANNUAL GENERAL REPORT

Men made up **56%** of the total client group as shown in **Table 2**. **72.85%** of clients had lived in Australia for less than two years and would be classed as those most in need of support. Sudanese people made up **47.5%** of the client group followed by Liberians **20.8%**, Australian **17.9%**, Burundi's **12.5%** and Sierra Leone's and Rwandans the smallest number.

Table 2:

CLIENT CHARACTERISTICS												
Country of Birth/Ethnic Group Code	Sex		Years in Australia			Age				Humanitarian Entrant	First-time Client	TOTAL No. Of Clients
	FEMALE	MALE	Under 2 yrs	2-5 yrs	5+ yrs	0<16 yrs	16<25 yrs	25<55 yrs	55+ yrs			
SUDANESE	103	152	205	34	16	38	81	133	3	255	67	255
LIBERIAN	48	64	112			14	43	47	8	112	40	112
AUSTRALIAN	54	42					17	51	28		26	96
BURUNDI	29	38	67			12	22	33		67	28	67
RWANDI		3	3				3			3	2	3
SIERRA LEONE	2	2	4				2	2		4	3	4
TOTAL	236	301	391	34	16	64	168	266	39	441	166	537

Number of Clients for Face-to-Face Services from October 2004 to November 2005

GROUP WORK

In this year **30** information sessions were organised around Newcastle and lower hunter region to specific groups of clients and these include; 7 on community development, 3 health, 1 youth issues, 1 Housing, 4 employment, 5 African cultural awareness, 3 settlement information, 2 education issues. In addition, 4 sessions were organised on African and Sudanese cultural awareness at Tamworth, Armidale and Lismore although the majority were held in Newcastle and Urri-Urri, more than **648** people attended these sessions. The Sudanese, Liberian and Burundi's Communities have formed community organisations. The Sudanese community meetings take place sometimes at the Islington Baptist Church. Most African communities met at the Migrant Resource Centre.

OTHER WORK

- ❖ Working with Samaritans Foundations to establish extra English Classes for all African Students Primary/High School – titled Newcastle African and Australian Learning Activities (NAALA). Commenced October 22, and **40** Students attended first day. (Saturday's at St. Augustine Anglican Church at Merewether).
- ❖ Guest speaker at NSW Regional Communities Consultative Council of Department of Lands session "African Refuges Resettlement in Rural/Regional areas of NSW".
- ❖ African Communities Settlement information session for service providers around Newcastle and lower hunter in partnership with Communities Relations Commission (CRC) and Premiers Department considered African settlement & issues/problems in their resettlement in Newcastle and Hunter areas. (Over **28** attended from different agencies)
- ❖ Unisex Health Sessions organised by Migrant Health Unit in partnership with CSSS and Adult Migrant English Program at Newcastle Campus (TAFE) with all AMEP students, **51** males and **41** female attended the session. Interpreters were provided for each group.
- ❖ Attended two Urri-Urri Housing Forums, two Charlestown Centrelink Youth Forums.

Simon Majur Pabek

African Youth Worker Community Settlement Services Scheme

Funded by Department of Immigration, Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs
Manyang Arob



This program started on the 1st July 2005 and I commenced the work from 1st August 2005.

The aim of the project is to identify and addresses the issues of young Sudanese and other emerging young people of African background across the areas of Newcastle and lower Hunter. The targeted group is aged between 12-24 yrs.

The program runs through participation in local and regional youth and community networks.

The position aims to increase youth participation in existing services and where necessary, to develop responses to cover gaps in youth services provisions, especially with small and emerging communities.

Main purpose for this project is to provide support, information, referral, casework, service planning and development and capacity building to assist in settlement of African new entrants in Newcastle and Lower Hunter.

SKILL DEVELOPMENT

As part of skill development, the CSSS worker had attended the introduction to CSSS (module 1) in Department of Immigration and Multicultural and Indigence Affairs in Sydney on September.

I have also attended a conference organised by the Statewide Youth Action & Policy Association in Darling Harbour in Sydney, for two days, on September 13 and 14.

RECREATIONS & ACTIVITIES

Various sports activities have been established as a way of encouraging young people's participation in partnership with Newcastle Police Citizens Youth Club (PCYC), Samaritans Foundations and the Newcastle Basketball association.

This program runs on weekly basis every Thursday at PCYC hall at Broadmeadow.

YOUTH EMPLOYMENT

Youth unemployment is a huge issue for all young African people, and in Newcastle and Hunter Region much more than elsewhere in NSW. This impacts greatly on young people's social and economic disadvantage. However, the worker has been able to raise awareness and knowledge of employment, vocational and educational needs of refugee and migrant young people in conjunction with employment consultant of the MRC and various other job search networks. As a result of this effort, some young African people have been referred for vocational training.

To some extent, about 21-23 young African people had been referred to work at Tamworth and Wallengarah.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

A large number of young African people are enrolled in various schools around Newcastle and Hunter Region.

Since August 1st, 2005 up to October 31st 2005, the worker has been working with schools for the purpose of integrating the newly arrived young people into the main stream and to build their confidence and to break the language barriers between African young people and mainstream young people.

Table 1 gives an indication of the numbers of these young people the project is currently working with. As can be seen the Sudanese young people have made up the largest grouping comprising 80 percent of those linking to the project. School provides a relatively easy access to engaging them.

Table 1: Number of African Youth (12-24 years) in Newcastle and the Hunter Region

Background	Numbers
Sudanese	78
Burundi	13
Liberians	7
Rawandis	1
Total	99

In conclusion, this is a very new MRC project, which focuses on the direct needs of African young people. The strategies developed relate to partnership building with other agencies, schools and the young people themselves.

Manyang Arob

New England Project Worker Community Settlement Services Scheme

Funded by Department of Immigration & Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs
Leesa Moore

CSSS PROJECT NEW ENGLAND – ARMIDALE, TAMWORTH AND INVERELL

I took up the position of CSSS Project Coordinator on 6 April 2005, I have a great deal of news that is outlined below:

OFFICE RELOCATION

One of my first tasks was to investigate and arrange new office space. This was sorted out and the project moved to 146 – 151 Beardsley Street, Armidale NSW 2350. Relocation occurred during April and May 2005 this office is a large space with kitchenette and room for meetings, the office is centrally located in the Armidale Mall.

NEW ENGLAND MULTICULTURAL INTERAGENCY

During 2005, the MRC has facilitated the New England Multicultural Interagency, these meetings have been rotated between Armidale and Tamworth on a 3 monthly basis and are largely attended by service providers such as, Health, Job Network Agencies, TAFE, Centrelink and AMES. This interagency will expand to include a meeting in Gunnedah during 2006.

SUPPORTING SETTLEMENT NEEDS - ARMIDALE COMMUNITY

Over the past year the CSSS has worked with service providers, community organisations and clients to provide settlement services such as migrant assistance, access to childcare and access to employment. I have attended the local Interagency meetings to promote the service and also facilitated discussions between the AMEP program at TAFE and UNE to streamline service provision.

CSSS is assisting in facilitating health clinics for Sudanese families in Armidale in collaboration with Hunter New England Area Health Service, Multicultural Health Unit, the New England Division of General Practice, local Doctors and the Armidale Sanctuary Group.

CSSS is facilitating a NATTI training course, which will hopefully be run at TAFE during 2006 in collaboration with TAFE, NHEAH and Centrelink. Currently there are no NATTI accredited interpreters in the New England area.

SUPPORTING SETTLEMENT NEEDS - TAMWORTH COMMUNITY

During 2005 Tamworth has seen secondary settlement of a community of approximately 30 young Sudanese men. This community has settled in Tamworth to work at a local abattoir in response to this the CSSS project has facilitated English language classes at 2 of the household. These classes take place 3 nights per week for 2 hours after work and are focusing on the Standard Operating Procedures at the work place. Six of the group have just been made permanent employees.





To support the settlement needs of this group as well as migrants from other backgrounds the Tamworth Refugee & Migrant Support Group formed during September 2005. This group consists of individuals and church groups from the Tamworth community and provides assistance to support the role of the CSSS worker. The group provides access to language classes, Centrelink, education, schooling and childcare, social activities and has taken on facilitation of the Tamworth Migrant Women's Support Group.

The group is currently looking at supporting the needs of Sudanese who have sponsored their families in Africa and supporting Sudanese families once they start arriving to settle in Tamworth.

There are skilled migrants currently working in Health in New England especially Tamworth support of these clients largely involves access to Language support, Centrelink, Immigration Assistance and childcare.

SUPPORTING SETTLEMENT NEEDS - INVERELL COMMUNITY

The CSSS project has attended Inverell Interagency meetings on a regular basis and has visited service providers to promote the CSSS in Inverell. Inverell has a small community of Sudanese refugees who were sponsored by Inverell Sanctuary Group the CSSS and DET have provided support to this community mainly regarding settlement issues at local Inverell High Schools.

The CSSS project will look at forming a support group similar to that in Tamworth to support outreach work given that outreach is only one day per one month.

THE WIDER COMMUNITY NEW ENGLAND

Currently, Wallengarah, a small town on the border of NSW and QLD is settling African refugees to work at an abattoir. The CSSS project will work in collaboration with TAFE to support language needs of this group.

Gunnedah will see the opening of two new mines during 2006, which may also see the settlement of refugee's and migrants for work. The CSSS will set up an Information hub in Gunnedah to provide information for the existing community of migrants and refugees and any future settlement.

I would like to take this opportunity to thank the MRC Management Committee & staff of the MRC, for supporting my work in the New England area.

Leesa Moore

PHOTOS: Refugee Week BBQ – Tamworth hosted by the Tamworth Refugee & Migrant Support Group on Saturday, 29 October 2005.

Volunteer Resource Worker

Funded by Department of Immigration, Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs
Pat Dring



The six months I have spent as Volunteer Resource Worker, for two days a week from mid-April 2005 to mid-October 2005, have been busy and productive. The main group I have worked with has been the Community Support for Refugees (CSR) Group, and I have also liaised with volunteers from St Vincent de Paul, the Samaritans and HomeStart.

All these volunteers support African refugees in a variety of ways – welcoming them on their arrival and helping them settle into private rental housing; providing furniture, blankets and clothing; educating them in using household equipment such as washing machines, stoves etc.; assisting with shopping and transport to appointments; taking families to community events such as sporting fixtures, concerts, to beaches, picnics; assisting with English language and homework, and generally being good friends and neighbours.

In April there were **19** active CSR volunteers and **11** inactive volunteers. I interviewed **36** new volunteers from April to October, and in mid-October there were **38** active CSR volunteers and **16** inactive volunteers. These figures indicate that volunteers are a very fluid workforce, with people moving in and out with changing circumstances. The “inactive” members are inactive for a variety of reasons – illness, personal or family problems, extended holidays; some have moved into paid employment and are waiting to see what time they have available, and several will simply “contact us when they are ready”.

One of my first tasks was to develop an **Orientation Kit** for new volunteers (which was also gratefully received by ongoing members). The kit contained information on the CSR Group, the MRC, the IHSS (Integrated Humanitarian Settlement Strategy), volunteer policies and procedures, maps of Africa, and maps and background information on the main refugee groups coming into the Hunter, OH&S suggestions and public transport brochures. Over **60** kits have been distributed, to agencies dealing with refugees as well as to the volunteers.

I am leaving the position because I have other commitments, but I leave it in good hands. **Paul Sidebottom** (right), one of the CSR volunteers is continuing in the job for one day a week.



During the six months the volunteers and myself were extremely impressed by the outstanding work of the “refugee team” of Tima, Louise, Roz and Simon. It has been a privilege to assist them in the settlement of such needy African families. It has also been a stressful time, with the transition of the IHSS from the MRC to the ACL consortium. The future direction of the CSR Group is still uncertain, but whatever happens we know that the volunteers will still be there, welcoming and supporting refugee families.

The old Chinese curse states, “May you live in interesting times”. It has been interesting, but very rewarding to have worked with such dedicated colleagues and generous volunteers.

Pat Dring

Journeys from Africa – Destination Hunter A 'Living in Harmony' Project

Funded by Department of Immigration, Multicultural & Indigenous Affairs

Cathy Johnston



This part-time project, funded for 12 months from 1 October 2004 – 30 September 2005 by DIMIA, focussed on new arrivals from Africa and targeted those with reasonable English language skills who were prepared to tell their story to school students and community groups. The project was designed both to create greater community awareness about these new, very visible, settlers and also to build confidence in the speakers when connecting with the broader community.

Ambassadors: Volunteers participated in 1 of 3 separate training sessions – held in November, January and July. The sessions were 2 hours X 4 weeks and **19** 'ambassadors' received certificates – at Harmony Day in March or Refugee Week in October. A visitor from Toastmasters' International and a member of the Newcastle Speakers' Club evaluated the speakers. Appointments were made for them to speak to community groups and to school students and **40** presentations were made during the year. The project had a target figure of **1500** people to hear these stories with **2617** being the final number.

Club evaluated the speakers. Appointments were made for them to speak to community groups and to school students and **40** presentations were made during the year. The project had a target figure of **1500** people to hear these stories with **2617** being the final number.

Community groups spoken to include:

- Ethnic Communities Council childcare workers and staff
- Rotary Clubs (5)
- NRMA staff
- Probus Clubs (2)
- Lions Club
- Hunter Women's Centre – staff and clients
- Centrelink – staff and managers
- Community groups: World Vision, Westlakes Palliative Care group, Newcastle Speakers' Club
- School staff and parent groups
- Social Work Students – University
- Church groups: Salvation Army, Samaritans volunteers, St Peter's – men's and women's groups, Wesley Fellowship
- 'Homestart' Program volunteers (2 groups)

Requests continue to be made for speakers, with Newcastle Police, State Transit and another Probus Club interested.

Schools' Competition: Appointments were made for ambassadors to speak to school students who then had the opportunity to write their responses to the talk and to make suggestions as to how to make Newcastle a more welcoming place for refugees. They were encouraged to respond in a variety of ways – posters, cartoons, PowerPoint etc – and the results from the winning entries have been collated onto a CD, which will be distributed to schools and libraries.

2005 ANNUAL GENERAL REPORT

Winners:

Media	Prize	School Year	School
Moving panels	\$100	Year 5/6K	Mayfield East PS
CD	B Y P P	Year 5/6	Jesmond PS
Posters x 3	B Y F/M	Year 9	St Joseph's HS Aberdeen
Poem	B Y	Student - Year 6W	St Joseph's PS East Maitland
Laminated poster	B Y	Student - Year 5/6T	Waratah PS
Poem	B S	Student - Year 6W	St Joseph's PS East Maitland
Comic Strip	B S	Student - Year 5	St Columban's Mayfield
PowerPoint	B S	Student - Year 5/6T	Waratah PS
Cartoon Strip	B P	Student - Year 6	St Columban's Mayfield
Painting	B Y	Student - Year 4	New Lambton South PS
Poster	B Y	Student - Year 4	Lambton PS
Poster	B P	Student - Year S2A	Lambton PS
Poster	B S	Student - Year 4	New Lambton South PS
Poster	B P	Student - Year 5/6	Lambton PS
Poem	B P	Student - 5/6T	Waratah PS

Prizes for the competition came from the following sponsors:

Centrelink - \$100; **AJ Mayr Engineering** - \$100; **Newcastle PCYC Youth Program** - \$100; **Newcastle PCYC** - 6 memberships for 2006 (**P**); **Young People's Theatre** - 6 free tickets (**Y**); **Surfest Surf School** - 4 group surfing lessons (**S**); **KFC** - a Family Meal deal (**F**); **McDonalds Family Restaurants (M)** - \$20.00 voucher (2 cash prizes were converted into book vouchers **B**).

This project has been very beneficial to the ambassadors, school students and the community in general. The well-attended Harmony Day celebration helped to promote the very positive aspects of African settlement locally and the closing function at Refugee Week emphasised the excellent community links forged by this *Living in Harmony* initiative.

Thank you to the hardworking team at the front of the office, who have provided efficient, timely and creative support. Thank you, too, to the Management Committee for its on-going support and to all the staff for making this such a wonderful place to work.

Cathy Johnston

African Family Support Project – Families First

Funded by Department of Community Services

Iqbal Al-smadi



The African Family Support Project started in May this year.

This new project is funded by the Department of Community Services - Families First in NSW, to support and improve family dynamics, increase awareness among parents of the health and well being of small children and increase their capacity to be more confident and independent in their parenting practices in new culture, with new rules, obligation, and expectation.

CLIENT GROUP

The clients are African families identified as most at risk, with children under five. The areas covered include Maitland, Lake Macquarie and Newcastle.

CLIENT STATISTICS

This service has provided assistance and support to about **40** families within the last six months. 9 families are supported at one time.

By providing home based service with flexible durations through regular home visits to increase their knowledge about different issues like child development, health and immunisation, managing day to day duties like budgeting, shopping, and try to link them with an appropriate community services.

Providing support during stressful times such as illness, DV, etc.

Provide physical assistance for example in transport, accommodation, and shopping.

Provide material assistance in filling forms, and translation.

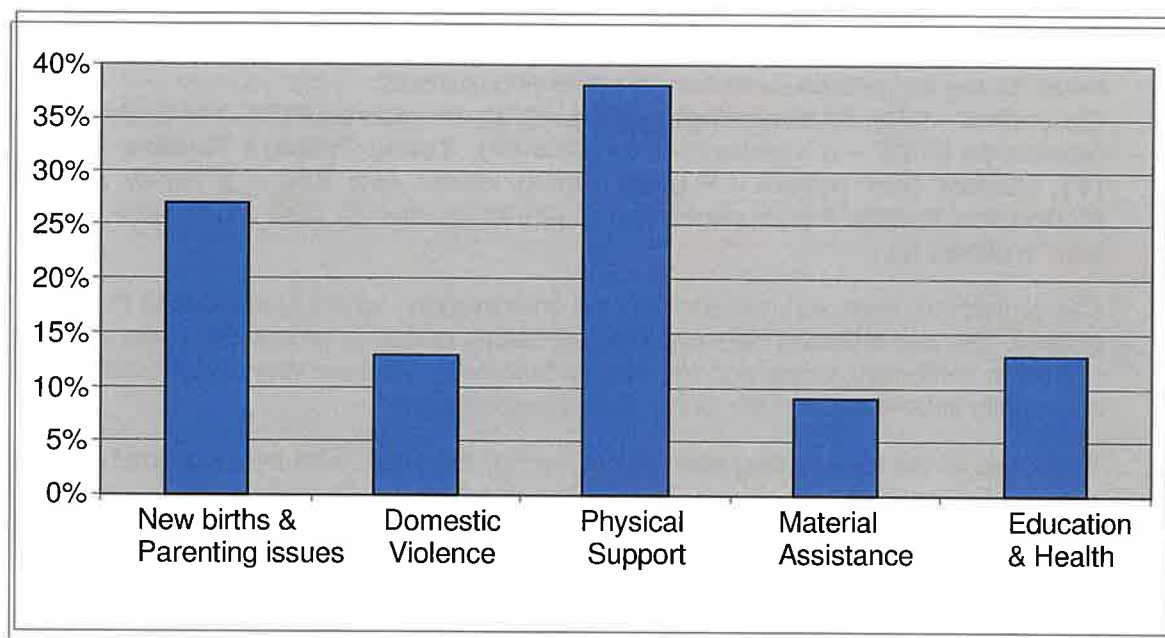


Figure 1: Types of issues presented by target client group

AFRICAN WOMEN'S GROUP

I have organised an African Women's group, which is meeting regularly every three weeks. 15 Women or sometimes more have been attending the group.

I have also organised a number of sessions in Nutrition, Parenting, Stings and Bites, Transport Information, Gardening Information and First Aid. These have been well attended. The women are interested & open to learning.

These sessions were in corporation with Newcastle Family Support Services, Migrant Health Unit, and the CALD transport induction project worker.

ADMINISTRATION

A flyer has been created and distributed as an invitation for the Women's group as well as other relevant forms associated with the operation of the project.

NETWORKING

Networks have been developed with the following agencies:

DoCS, Hunter New England Health Service, Migrant Health, Family Support Services, Centrelink, Home Start, Newcastle City Council, Department of Housing, TAFE, Ethnic Communities Council, STARTS, Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre.

CASE PLANNING AND MANAGING

Clients are referred to this service either as self-referrals or by other agencies.

Once they access the service, their needs are identified and met, and they are linked to other services if required. Support is provided by this project, through home visits and clients are accompanied to their appointments if necessary. They are also provided with basic counselling and other basic living & life skills.

When the client's enquiry is met, they are exited from the program and a new client is taken on.

TRAINING/MEETINGS ATTENDED

Department of Housing
Hunter Refugee Support Network
Centrelink Multicultural Forum
STARTS
Hunter CALD Advisory Group
Home Start
CALD (women from culturally and linguistically diverse background with Disability or carer)
Forum

Iqbal Al-smadi

Multicultural Family Support Project - Families First

Funded by Department of Community Services

Devika Wijewardene



During the 12-month period a total of **66** families have accessed this service from the Newcastle and Lake Macquarie areas. Of this, **24** families received assistance outside of 9 – 5 pm and during the weekends and public holidays.

Of all the **66** families who accessed the service either one or both parents were from culturally and linguistically diverse (CALD) backgrounds.

During the 12 months period clients from **38** countries were assisted.

TYPES OF ISSUES PRESENTED:

(Each family would have one or more of the following issues)

Assistance Provided	No of Clients
Domestic Violence	26
Housing Issues	20
Legal Issues	9
Isolation	30
Child/mother with disability	22
Antenatal/postnatal needs	7
Home Visits	66

Figure 1: Types of issues presented:

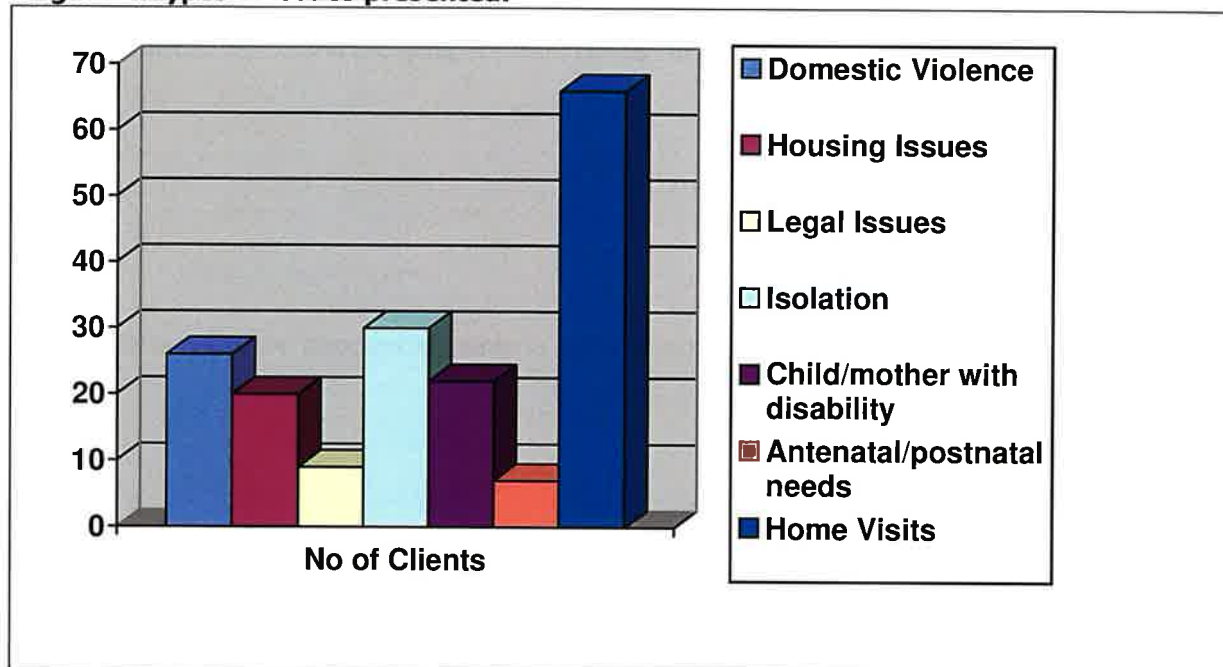
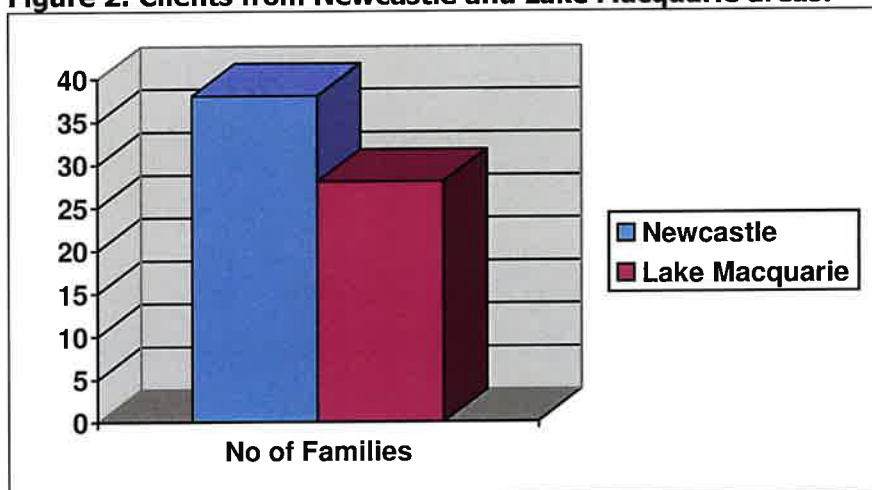


Figure 2: Clients from Newcastle and Lake Macquarie areas:



NETWORKING:

Worked in partnership with the Migrant Health Unit, Disability Services, Home Start Newcastle and the Hunter, Men's program at the Newcastle family support services, and the court support services.

Worked with Hunter Family Support Services, Hunter Women's refuges, Hunter Area Health, Migrant Health, Kaleidoscope child health unit, Ethnic Communities Council, Multicultural Neighborhood Centre Local charities and churches, TAFE, Family Court, Newcastle Court, Eva's Project, Women's Housing, NewMacque, DOCS, Legal Aid, Waratah Police and Department of Housing.

CASE MANAGEMENT:

Clients accessed this service through referrals from other services, through self-referrals, Centre based referrals and through other clients who had support from this service.

On going case management was provided for the clients with support through home visits, counseling, by accompanying families to appointments and linking them to other appropriate services to achieve the best outcome for the clients.

Support Group for the women with young children was started. Parenting group was conducted for African Families with the Eastlake's Family Support Services working as facilitators.

It has been a very productive and result oriented year for this project and I would like to thank the Director, staff and the Management Committee for their support.

Devika Wijewardene

Filipino Welfare Project

Funded by Department of Community Services

Pet M. C. Kelly



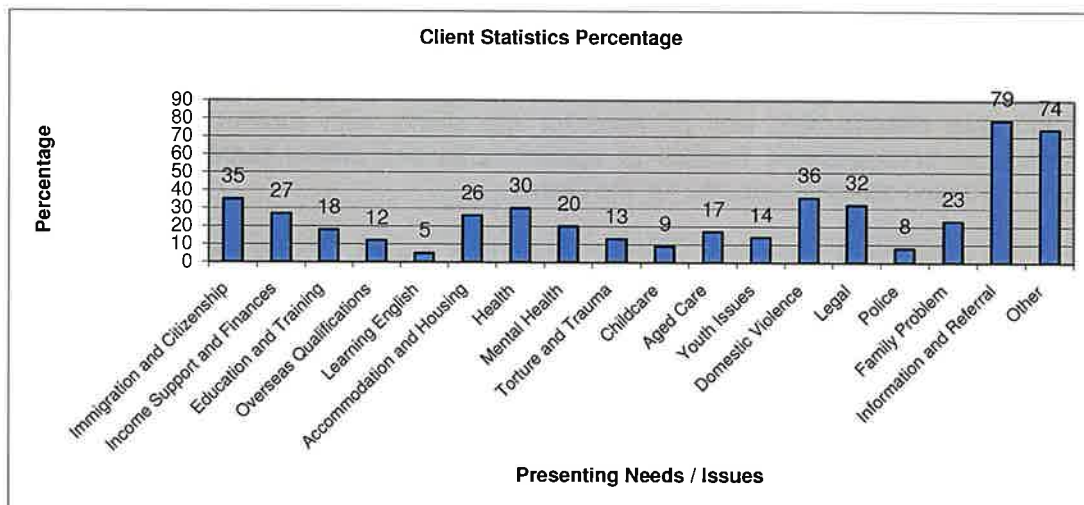
Reflecting on the year is always a challenge and as I look back on the past 12 months, I ask myself...what have I done? Have I made a difference?

In answering these questions, during the year I have provided the Filipino community with the following services:

- Provision of quality bilingual information and referral both on individual and group basis
- Assist and empower individuals and families in crisis, generally resulting from domestic violence situations
- Advocacy on behalf of individual Filipinos/families
- Facilitation of access to employment and training opportunities
- Consultancy to other service providers regarding Filipino cultural issues to assist in a more sensitive and relevant service provision
- Support for community development activities among Filipinos, such as Cultural functions and events

CLIENT STATISTICS

From November 2004 to November 2005, I have assisted 300 people with a variety of problems and issues. Some of them presented problems that were complex and at times stressful. On many occasions a client presented a number of concerns and difficulties. The issues faced by clients are described in the following table:



As can be seen from the statistics, client information and referral services, form a significant part of my work, followed by domestic violence, immigration and legal matters.

Other services include social/emotional problems, supporting letters, transport difficulties, filling up forms, interpreting, translation of documents, suicide, death/bereavement, separation/divorce, harassment/discrimination, traffic offences, compensation, conflict outside of marriage, lost passport and renewals, cultural and educational information, the need for referee, access to belongings, gambling problems, Philippine birth certificate authentication, neighbourhood dispute, employer/employee dispute, income tax return lodgement, lost ATO Notice of Assessment, JP duties, etc.

COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT

I have organised the following for the Filipino community:

- Consultation re: Health Issues of Filipinos with Carmen Vecchi, Multicultural Health Liaison Officer
- Coordinated MRC Filipino Social Group/End of the Year Party
- Health Information Sessions (in partnership with Hunter New England Health Unit, with Carmen Vecchi: Back Care, Relaxation, Dementia, Benefits of Exercises, Our Bones, Save a Life (Organ Donation)
- Seminar on Food Preparation, Handling, Transport & Legal Issues/Policy on 'Sale of Cooked Food' with a speaker from Health & Environmental Services of Newcastle City Council
- Information Session on Philippine Citizenship Retention & Reacquisition Act 2003 known as Dual Citizenship with Philippine Consular officials from Sydney as guest speakers
- Session between an Employment Recruitment Agency and MRC Filipino Social Group at the MRC re: a Flower Farm wanting to hire Filipino women

OTHER ACTIVITIES

During the year I have attended the following:

♦ Department of Fair Trading 2004 Think Smart Ethnic Media & Community Leaders Conference in Sydney ♦ DoCS Seminar 'Identifying & Responding to Children & Young People at Risk of Harm' ♦ Westlakes DV Committee Meeting ♦ Info Session 'Enduring Guardianship & Power of Attorney' ♦ Meeting with new Consul-General at Philippine Consulate (Sydney) ♦ Citizenship Ceremony at Newcastle City Hall ♦ Law Week Info Session ♦ Forum on Domestic Violence ♦ Filipino community & Philippine Consular official & Filipino Senator meeting ♦ MRC Planning Day ♦ Meeting Central Coast Flower Farm - employing Filipino women ♦ World Duathlon Event Press Conference ♦ Filipino DV Committee Network Meeting ♦ Home & Hospital visits, consultations & meetings with s/p's ie: Aged Care Hostels & Nursing Homes, Police, Chamber Magistrate, Women's & Children's Refuge Centres, ACAT, Centrelink Social Workers, Solicitors, Health Workers, Real Estates, DoH, Community Housing, VOCAL, TAFE, Philippine Consulate in Sydney, DOCS, Family Court, NCC, Legal Aid, HCLC, Newcastle Legal Centre, Protective Commissioner's Office, Building Society Financial Officer, Schools, MRC colleagues, Optus, etc. ♦ Newc Uni - Research project & a TAFE placement student ♦ Dancing Lessons (Ballroom) for the Filipino Social Group ♦ Attended on a regular basis: MRC staff meetings, MRC Caseworkers meetings, Migrant Forum & CALD meetings ♦ Justice of the Peace duties (JP)

Once again, it has been a very hectic and a challenging year for me. I have however, terrific support from my colleagues at the centre and I would like to take the opportunity to thank them. Thank you too, to the MRC Management Committee for their most valued support to the Filipino Welfare Service.

Pet M. C. Kelly

Multicultural Family Support Worker

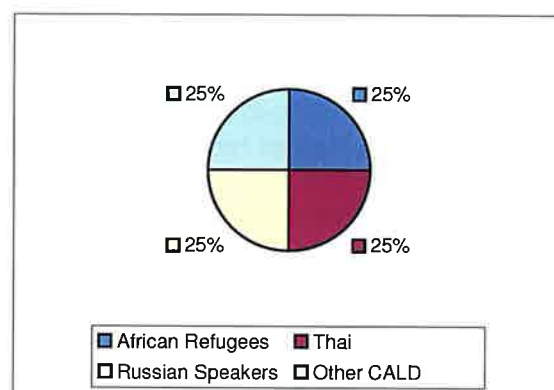
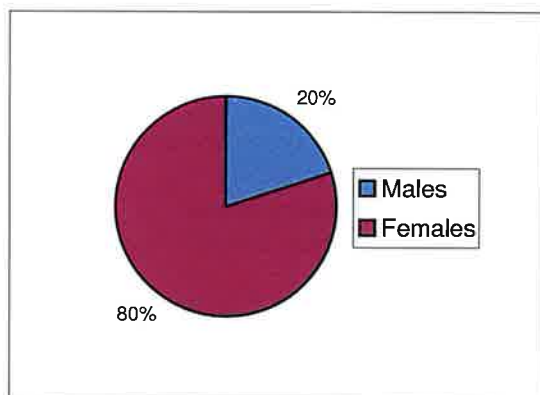
Funded by Department of Community Services

Tima 'Oto ♦ Alla O'Regan ♦ Juanita Loli ♦ Nellie Srisurapon

This year, the activities of the Family Support Worker focused on responding to the needs of newer & emerging communities in the Local Government Areas of Newcastle & Lake Macquarie, such as recent African refugee arrivals, Thai, Russian speakers & other CALD people.

The service provided approximately **1400** occasions of services assisting **30–40** clients per month.

CLIENT PROFILE:



Overall, client backgrounds have presented the wide range of ethnicity that this program has been serving in the thirteen years of its operation. Up to **43** ethnic backgrounds were represented.

COUNTRY OF ETHNIC ORIGIN		
Afghan	Indonesia	Somalia
Australia	Iraq	South Africa
Austria	Italy	Spain
Bosnia	Japan	Sudan
Brazil	Liberia	Tahiti
Burundi	Macedonia	Thailand
China	New Zealand	The Rep of Congo
England	Panama	Tunisia
Fiji	Papua New Guinea	Ukraine
Finland	Philippines	Uruguay
France	Poland	Venezuela
Germany	Rwanda	Vietnam
Greece	Russia	Zimbabwe
Honduras	Samoa	
India	Sierra Leone	

CLIENT PROFILE:

Table 1: Issues presented by clients

Problem/Issue	No of Instances	Problem/Issue	No of Instances
Family/Parenting	280	Language	130
Housing	90	Employment/Education	90
Domestic Violence	155	Other/Referral	185
Legal	85	Health	155
Income Support	230	TOTAL	1400

SERVICES PROVIDED:

Table 2: Services provided to individuals & families

Services Provided	No of Instances	Services Provided	No of Instances
General Information	300	General Support	200
Counseling	219	Court Support	21
Advocacy	95	Filling Forms Assist.	88
Consultancy	70	Home Visits	50
Referrals	144	Agency Visits	70
Mediation	143	TOTAL	1400

GROUPWORK

The service facilitated meetings of several support groups on a monthly basis & also well as ad hoc meetings for convened special purposes such as health, legal, migration information & women's needs.

- **Thai Friendship Group** – Conducted **10** meetings in the year, with an average attendance of **20** individuals per session.
- **Russian Speakers** – **5** information sessions were held specifically for the Russian speakers on the following issues: Health, Transport, Legal, Women's Issues & Citizenship.
- **Sudanese Women's Support Group** remained active, focusing on cultural & craft activities & met on a weekly basis. Presentation on a number of issues relating to Health, Parenting Skills etc, resulting in a reduction of social isolation & the strengthening of social support networks.

The service has also worked collaboratively to support activities of other Centre based projects, especially the Refugee Service which has continued to play a major role in the settlement of families, a task which continues to be very challenging.



Tima Oto
(African Refugees)



Alla O'Regan
(Russian Speakers)



Juanita Loli
(Other CALD)



Nellie Srisurapon
(Thai Worker)

Community Aged Care Packages

Funded by Commonwealth Department of Health & Ageing

Sue (Slavica) Hristov

Lupe Fonua

The CACP Project is in its fifth year of successful operation. It continues to provide a wide range of home based care and assistance to frail aged people from Non English Speaking Background (NESB) who wish to remain living at home as long as possible.

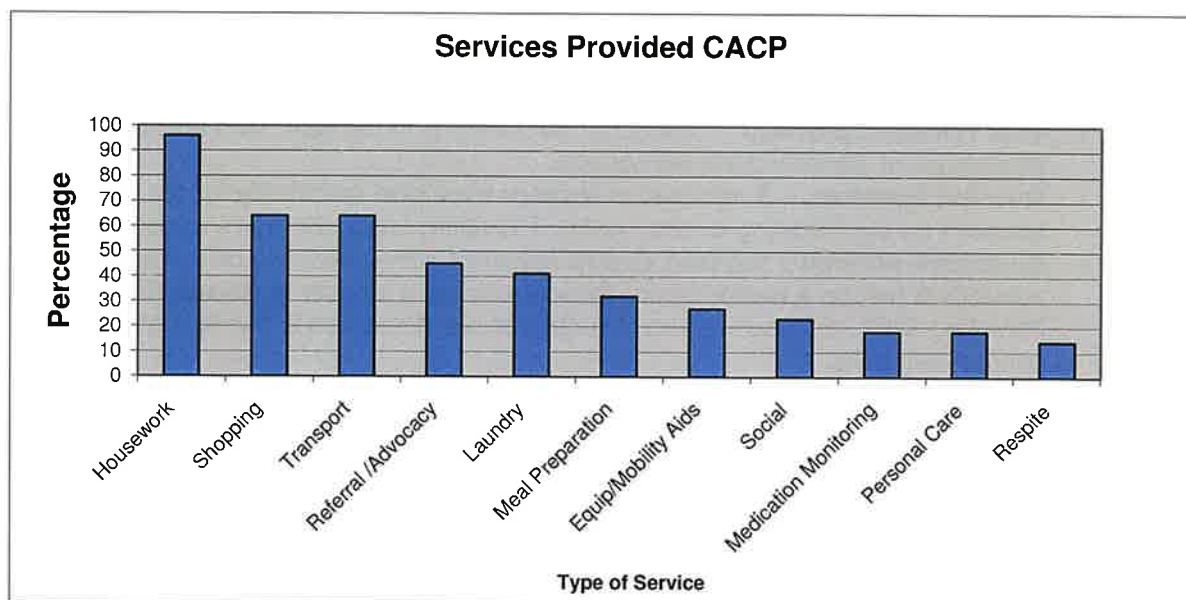


Earlier this year we said goodbye to one of our part time Coordinators, Sulu Lolohea,

who left to take up a Social Work position at a local hospital- she will be sadly missed. However, we were fortunate to obtain the services of Lupe Fonua, both as part time CACP Coordinator and Tongan Welfare Worker.



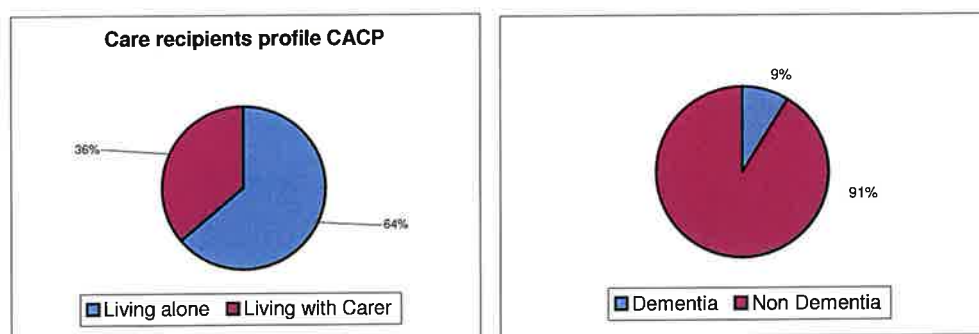
SERVICES PROVIDED



On average we provide about 3.5 hrs of help per week for each care recipient- some only need 1 –2 hrs per week and some up to about 9 hrs.

CARE RECIPIENT PROFILE

We are currently providing assistance to **22** people (or 22 packages) to care recipients living in the Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Maitland and Port Stephens local government areas - **16** females and **6** males. As the following chart shows the majority of our care recipients live alone while the others have either a partner or a Carer who lives with them and 9% have a diagnosis of dementia.



The care recipients come from a variety of cultural backgrounds: Italy, Greece, Poland, Ukraine and Germany, Sri Lanka, Macedonia and Hungary.

MODEL OF SERVICE PROVISION

The Coordinators are responsible for the considerable case management component of the packages which involves ongoing monitoring and responding to care recipient's changing health and other needs as well as referral and advocacy with other community services such as community nurses, doctors, physiotherapists, podiatrists, respite organizations etc. It also involves more intensive assistance on discharge from hospital and at other times of personal or health related crisis experienced by care recipients.

The direct service provision is contracted to a number of brokerage agencies. Having a choice of a larger pool of care workers has proven to be an efficient and effective means of being able to meet the individual cultural and linguistic needs of our care recipients.

NEW ACCOUNTABILITY FRAMEWORK

In order to ensure quality service provision the Department of Health and Ageing has introduced new accountability requirements for CACPs this year. Based on a continuous improvement model it will involve a desk audit, followed by a site visit.

We wish to thank management, particularly Violetta, and fellow colleagues at MRC for their invaluable assistance and support during a very challenging year - a Safe and Happy Festive season to everyone - may life be good to you in the New Year.

Lupe Fonua & Sue (Slavica) Hristov

Hunter Multicultural Respite Service

Funded by Department of Ageing, Disability & Home Care (DADHC)
– Home & Community Care (HACC) Program

Christine Follett



Hunter Multicultural Respite Service (HMRS) is a new service auspiced to MRC in early 2005. The service provides respite care for frail older people or people with dementia from non-English speaking backgrounds experiencing difficulty in attending Day Care Centres. The service provides a culturally appropriate worker to assist with care of clients at Day Care Centres to sustain the placement at Day Care and to provide the carers some respite.

MODEL OF SERVICE PROVISION

HMRS, is staffed by one part-time coordinator (3 days per week). Direct care services are provided on a brokerage model, i.e. care workers are contracted as needed from other existing providers such as Uniting Care, Homecare and Extracare. The brokerage model has proven to be an efficient and effective model, as it enables the

project to have a wider pool of workers to choose from and enables the service to better meet the cultural and linguistic needs of particular clients as well as ensuring all insurance issues are covered.

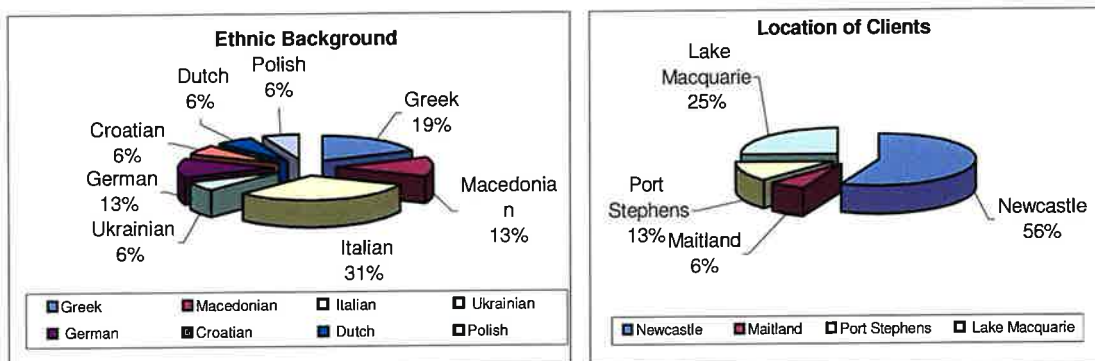
SERVICES PROVIDED

Day Care Centre	No of Clients	Total hours of Service	Comments
Greek Day Care	3	17 hours per week	Including travel for 1 client twice p/wk
Holy Apostles Day Care	1	2.5 hours per week	Including travel Referred to COPs
Macedonian Day Care	2	8 hours per week	Including travel for 1 client
Italian Day Care	4	16 hours per week	1 client referred to ACAT
Sandcastle Activity Centre, Williamtown	1	4 hours per week	
Maitland Multicultural Friendship Group	1	4 hours per fortnight	
Alkira Dementia Centre, Toronto	2	4 hours per week	1 client into nursing home in August
Wattle Grove Dementia Day Care, Wallsend	3	4 hours per week	
TOTAL	16	57.5 hours per week	1 client goes to both Greek Centres

- In addition a total of **20** carers have been supported by direct service provision.
- All clients have been reviewed after 6 months of service.
- There are no clients on waiting list & every client referred has been offered service.

CLIENT PROFILE

Client Characteristics						
Gender		Age			Client condition	
Male	Female	60-75	75-89	90+	Dementia	Frail Aged
6	10	5	8	3	10	6



ADMINISTRATION

The following administration tasks have been undertaken throughout the year:

- Policy and procedure manual completed.
- Promotional brochures and client handbooks have been created and translated into 12 relevant community languages.
- MDS statistics compiled and sent to DADHC quarterly.

MULTICULTURAL DEMENTIA SUPPORT GROUP

The service coordinates the monthly meeting of the group at the Migrant Resource Centre on the third Wednesday of the month. Throughout the year we have had speakers and information sessions to assist and support carers of migrants with dementia from the following organisations: Educare, Carelink, Baronie House and Central Dementia Service as well as various outings.

TRAINING / CONFERENCES attended throughout the year include:

- Alzheimer's Conference in Sydney (8-10 May)
- Seminar on Enduring Guardianship at West Leagues Club (17 May)
- Support Group Leaders' Workshop – Alzheimer's Australia (29 August)
- Healthy Ageing Expo, Alzheimer's Australia, Club Macquarie (12 Sept)
- Dementia Professional Forum- 'Demystifying Dementia', Combined Central Coast
- Primary Dementia Care Network and Hunter Dementia Forum, Mingara Recreation Club, Tumby Umbi (14 September)
- Information Session on the new DADHC Integrated Monitoring Framework & update on Minimum Data Set (23 September)
- HACC orientation (18 October)
- Dementia Care Competency Course (8-9 Nov, 22-23 Nov)

MEETINGS attended on a regular basis include:

- HMRS Advisory Committee
- Hunter Ethnic Aged Services Network
- HACC Services quarterly meetings
- Multicultural and Dementia Interagency meetings

I would like to thank the Management Committee & my colleagues at the MRC for their assistance and support, which was invaluable in starting the service and enabling the service to build so quickly.

Christine Follett

Multicultural Social Support Service Central Coast

Funded by Department of Ageing, Disability & Home Care (DADHC)
– Home & Community Care (HACC) Program

Coordinators: Olivia Fuente, Dusan Marjanovic ♦ Office Manager: Sharlene Huber

The service commenced after the MRC employed two coordinators and an office manager in February 2005.

The first 3 months were taken up with finding suitable premises to operate out of and to also introduce our service to the Central Coast community services and the community itself. We attended many meetings in this period, at an average of 12 p/week, visiting: Local HACC services, community/neighbourhood centres, ethnic community groups and other related services and organisations to inform them of the new service and to also get a clearer picture of other services/organisations existing on the Central Coast.

Late April, we found suitable premises in the Gosford area and immediately commenced equipping the office with all of the necessary equipment, technology and furniture.

Our next big task was to develop a service brochure and commence promoting the service in the community. The service promotion included: a large mail out of our service information to government and non-government organisations, local churches, community/neighbourhood centre's, ethnic community groups and a media release to all Central Coast commercial and community newspapers and radio stations.

VOLUNTEER RECRUITMENT

An advertising campaign assisted us to commence the recruitment of Volunteers.

A comprehensive Orientation Session and Volunteer Handbook were also developed to ensure the Volunteers were equipped with knowledge of the necessary policy and procedures.

To date, the service has **16** registered Volunteers, **5** of whom are actively servicing Clients, **2** had to resign due to work commitments, **3** have limited ability and the rest are waiting to be matched with suitable Clients. **Table 1** shows the Volunteer's distribution for the project.

The nationalities of the Volunteers are as follows: Australian, Spanish, Filipina, Malaysian, Czech, Serbian, and Greek.

Several Volunteer Orientation sessions have been held this year. Training for the Volunteers has also commenced with **6** Volunteers attending the 'Introduction to Dementia' training held. The next training event offered to the Volunteers will be held late November.

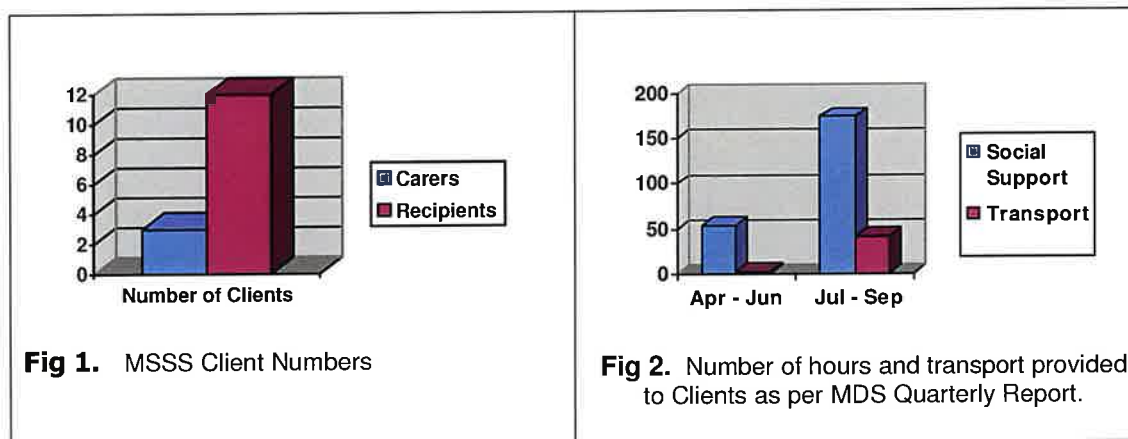
Table 1. Volunteer Distribution on the Central Coast

LGA	No. of Volunteers
Wyong	5
Gosford	11

CLIENTS

We started receiving Client referrals in March 2005 and the numbers are steadily increasing. This is shown in **Figure 1** below.

Figure 2 shows a significant increase in the total number of service hours and transport provided to Clients. This increase is evident by comparing the quarterly Minimum Data Set (MDS) figures that are submitted quarterly to our funding body. **(Figure 2)**



PROJECT ADVISORY COMMITTEE

An Advisory Committee was formed in April to support the project and provides representation from the following: Department of Ageing, Disability & Home Care, MRC, HACC, a Volunteer, Central Coast Health Carer Support, Aged Care Assessment Team, a Carer and the Australian Hellenic Association.

The Advisory Committee has met at varying times and has played an integral role in providing valuable feedback and advice for the Team, especially during the development of various documents. We thank the Committee for their participation and direction.

CHALLENGES FOR 2006

We plan to expand our involvement in local forums, community consultations, exhibition events and other activities, which would improve our visibility in CALD communities and help increase Client numbers.

Building and maintaining our pool of Volunteers is also going to be a challenge. We aim to continue advertising for new Volunteers as well as providing some social incentives for our current Volunteers.

Another test will be to initiate improvement in the interactions between detectable members of smaller ethnic groups and instigate the formation of networks that would reach any isolated members of their communities.

CONCLUSION

We are grateful to the MRC for giving us an opportunity to be a part of such large and well-respected organisation. The MRC's excellent reputation in dealing with existing and new CALD communities enables us to promote our service on the Central Coast with great ease.



(Left -Right)

Dusan Marjanovic
Olivia Fuente
Sharlene Huber

Community Visitors Scheme

Funded by Department of Commonwealth Department of Health and Ageing
Johanna Dupree



The Migrant Resource Centre's Community Visitor Scheme (MRCCVS) continues to provide a consistent, efficient, effective and highly valued visitors program to residents of a Migrant Background needing a visitor in lower Hunter nursing homes.

Over **740** face-to-face visits were conducted during this period and the distances travelled by the Visitors to provide their service totaled approximately **15670 kms**.

23 Nursing Homes in the Lower Hunter, especially the Lake Macquarie part of this area were regularly visited as part of the Scheme with **55** residents receiving visits. This is discussed in more detail below.

A new range of policy and procedure items were completed and are being incorporated into the overall Policy and Procedure Manual of the MRC. These will be reviewed annually to ensure best practice for the MRCCVS project. An area to be examined in this light in the next year will be to include the "Principles of the Charter of Service in an Multicultural Service" into these procedures.

COMMUNITY VISITOR RECRUITMENT AND TURNOVER

Table 1 shows the numbers of Community Visitors employed by the MRC Community Visitor Scheme during 2004 –05. As the table shows, the MRC CVS had **18** Active Visitors in the 12 months to the end of June 2005.

TABLE 1 Number of Community Visitors employed by the MRCCVS 2004-2005

Active Visitors (At the Beginning of July 2004)	Recruited during 2004-05	Visitors who withdrew from the Scheme (2004-05)
17	4	3

During this period, **3** Visitors withdrew from the Scheme for various reasons, mostly associated with poor health. Two developed severe illnesses and one's companion became very ill and caused the Visitor's withdrawal. This Visitor is expected to return in the future dependant on circumstances. A continuing issue for the Visitors is the distance travelled and the difficulties this poses with transport. As was mentioned earlier, the approximate distance the MRCCVS' Visitors travel is **15670** kms, or approximately 850 kilometres for each Visitor. In the Lower Hunter transport has been identified as the major issue for Volunteers, as lakes, dispersed settlements and towns and poor regular services all act to challenge services. Despite this, the loss of Visitors was limited with all remaining Visitors being very conscientious and enthusiastic.

Visitor recruitment continues to be an issue but pleasing to say **4** new Visitors joined the MRCCVS late in the year. The issue of Volunteer recruitment continues to be another issues for all services, none the least the MRCCVS.

One of the Hunter Ethnic Aged Network meetings (November 2004) attended by the Coordinator, focused on this topic with the speakers at the meeting not having an answer for services wishing to provide for elderly migrant clients. As can be seen the MRCCVS seeks to work in partnership with other local ethnic agencies to resolve this issue.

LEVELS OF METROPOLITAN ACTIVITY AND RURAL AND REMOTE ACTIVITY

The MRC Community Visitor Scheme covers **5** LGAs being Newcastle, Lake Macquarie, Port Stephens, Cessnock and Maitland. The Scheme had residents in **3** of the LGAs. Most of these LGAs have a rural – metropolitan interface. The spread of the MRC CVS is shown in

Table 2: Number of Nursing Homes Visited by LGA

LGA	Nursing Homes Currently Being Visited	Currently Stopped Visitation – resident passed away, etc (2004-5)	Total of Nursing Homes Visited in 2005
Newcastle	6	2	8
Lake Macquarie	7	4	11
Port Stephens	1	0	1
Cessnock	0	0	0
Maitland	0	0	0
Totals	14	6	20

The reason for the MRCCVS stopping a Visitor to a Nursing Home was usually due to a change in circumstances for the resident, with 5 residents passing away. The alternative problem was when a Visitor could not maintain contact due to their circumstances, which was a Visitor health issue.

ORIENTATION ACTIVITIES

As with previous years the Visitor's continued to have information sessions to update them on current issues, including a session on dementia. Another major issue for some of the MRCCVS is that information sessions on certain topics do raise individual fears for the Visitors. There can be a tendency for some Visitor to view the experiences of their residents as the road that they themselves will travel. Others are not affected and seek more information to better skill themselves in handling their visits.

CHANGES FOR THE FUTURE SERVICE PROVISION

We expect our CVS to continue to be a high need service. In fact we expect requests to increase in this year. Some of this will also occur due to revisiting many nursing homes in the region as well as ongoing telephone and Internet contact. We look forward to acquiring new Volunteers to meet some of this potential increase.

Johanna Dupree

CALD Transport Induction Project

Funded by Ministry of Transport

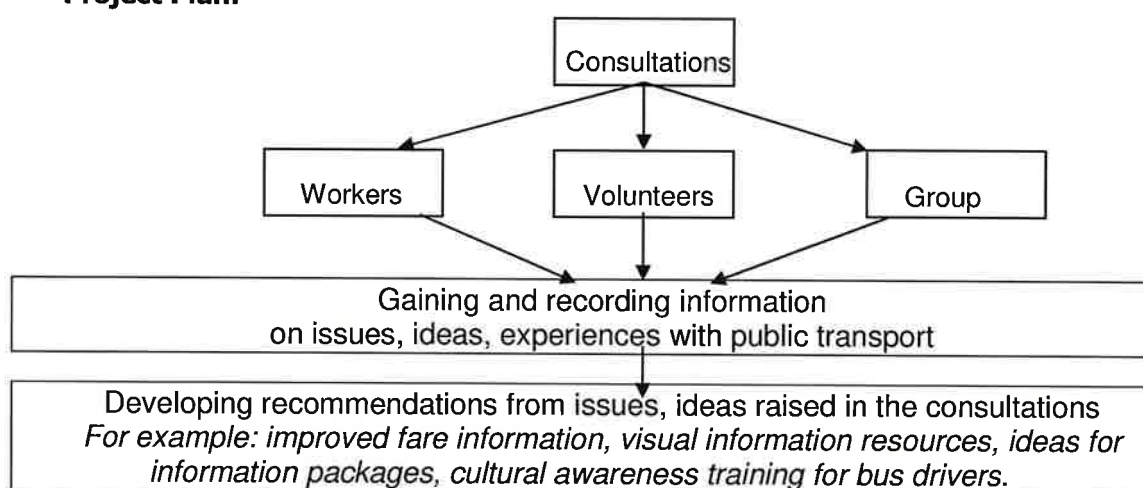
Carla Silva



The CALD Transport Project is a MRC based project, funded by the NSW Ministry of Transport and supported by the Regional Transport Coordinator from the Newcastle office of the Ministry of Transport. It is a six month, 6 hours per week project that began in July 2005.

The overall aim of the CALD Transport Induction Project is to assist newly arrived refugees and migrants to the Newcastle area in developing skills in 'getting around' their new community, accessing mainstream public and private transport services. The Project utilizes community consultations to provide information, improve awareness and gather qualitative information on CALD individuals' and communities' experience with Newcastle's transport system. The information gathered from community consultations will be reported back to the Ministry of Transport including possible recommendations to improve transport service provision to CALD communities. The Project has also consulted and provided information to volunteers, MRC staff and their clients to support them in transport related matters. A further aspect of the project is to distribute around 125 (75 adult and 50 child/concession) TimeTen travel passes, in Transport Induction Information packages, that will be provided to clients to encourage and assist them with initiating their travel on the public bus system. This has recently begun and will continue over the remaining two months of the project.

Project Plan:



To date consultations have been held with the following community groups:

- 11 August 2005 – African Women's Group – 7 participants
- 3 August 2005 – Newly Arrived African Family – Family Group
- 29 August 2005 – Community Refugee Support Volunteers – 30 Participants
- 19 September 2005 - MRC Caseworker Consultation – 4 participants
- 21 September 2005 - MRC African Support Workers' Consultation - 8 participants
- 14 October 2005 – Filipino Community Consultation – 15 participants
- 23 October 2005 – Japanese Community Consultation – 16 participants
- 5 November 2005 – Thai Community Consultation – 8 participants
- 10 November 2005 – follow up session with the African Women's Group

From these consultations I have provided follow up information and support in relation to documented issues, concerns and information needs. I have also provided transport support and information to a number people on an individual basis, including volunteers, clients and MRC staff.

To date approximately 180 Newcastle Transport Information kits have been distributed to people through community consultations, individual support, and MRC staff. These kits have included Newcastle Buses and Ferries Transport Information Guides, CALD Transport Project Factsheets (highlighting bus fare information, Newcastle City fare-free buses, Family Fare Deals and where to get further information), and recently, where appropriate, TimeTen bus tickets and a TimeTen ticket information sheet.

Some of the initial information gathered through consultations has highlighted that:

- Initial orientation the main difficulty experienced by newly arrived migrants, refugees and humanitarian entrants;
 - Identified that there is an approximate 3 months' transition to beginning to use public transport for newly arrived people to the Newcastle area.
- Finding out information initially is difficult for newly arrived people, even people who possess English skills.
 - General orientation information such as fares, routes, family fare deal, timetables, fare evasion are required in an accessible format (and appropriate community language) early after arrival to facilitate public transport use.
- Need for cultural awareness training for Bus Drivers and Revenue Protection Officers.
- Travel concession cards are only issued by Centrelink to benefit recipients who are registered as looking for work or who are students. This leaves a gap for other benefit recipients who are required to pay a full fare.
- Lack of public transport information available in other languages
- Some CALD groups possess limited knowledge of transport information, buses – family fare deals, concessions etc.

The CALD Transport Induction Project will conclude in early January with a report to the Hunter Regional Transport Coordinator from the Ministry of Transport, which will include information gathered in CALD community consultations, individual support sessions, and potential recommendations that will seek to improve information and access for CALD communities to Newcastle's public transport system.

Carla Silva

Computer Training For Seniors

Funded by Department of Ageing, Disability & Home Care (DADHC)

Daniel Follett



The course was designed to give seniors a better understanding of the wide range of information and services available to them via a computer system connected to the Internet in Australia.

The course was comprised of two hours per session, two to three times a week over a period of five weeks. It was arranged this way as the students had trouble concentrating longer than 2 hours per day.

Student skills varied somewhat. This problem was overcome by splitting the students into beginner and intermediate groups. This allowed the course to run more smoothly as students weren't waiting for others to finish.

Not all students had a firm grasp of written English because of their migrant background. While they had no trouble conversing in English, their written skills made exercises such as Internet searching and Word processing a little difficult. More intensive support was required in this area and one-to-one assistance was required to spell out more difficult words and/or type them for the student.

After completion students developed a good grounding in the following topics:

BASIC COMPUTER KNOWLEDGE

- General computer usage
- Windows navigation
- File/folder manipulation and creation
- What not to touch on your computer
- Peripheral devices eg Printer, Modem, Scanner
- Basic typing skills with an introduction to touch typing

INTERNET USAGE

- Methods of Internet searching
- Useful web sites
- Internet Banking
- Internet bill paying
- Internet security concerns

EMAIL AND MESSAGING

- Signing up for a free web based email account
- How to setup email software with your Internet Service Provider (ISP) email settings
- How to send attachments and emails to multiple people
- Information about instant messaging software

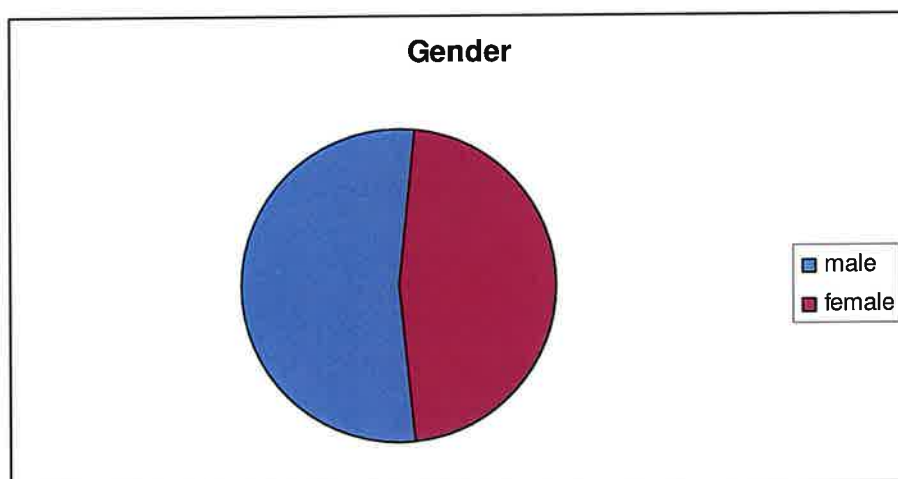
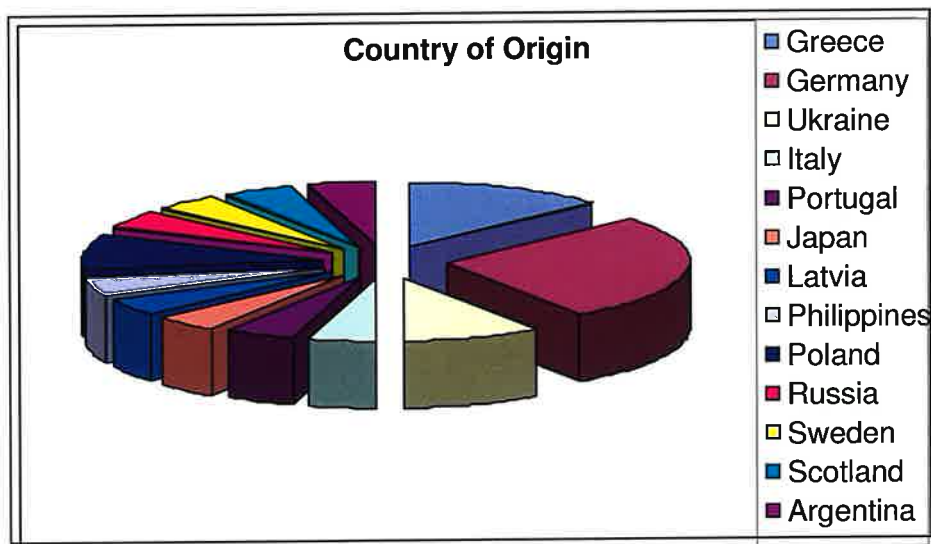
OTHER TOPICS

Suggestions were taken from the class for other topic areas, these included:

- CD/DVD Burning
- Photo editing and printing
- Networking two or more computers and sharing the Internet across
- Simple Web page design

STATISTICS

A total of nine courses were completed, servicing forty-five students all together. Their age ranged from fifty through to seventy-five. Country of Origin and gender are shown in the graphs below.



CONCLUSION

Feedback received from students was almost all positive. They felt as though they had improved their computing skills and reduced some of their concerns about living in the computer age. They became very proficient in Internet usage and e-mailing which enabled them to communicate more efficiently with family and friends from their country of origin. However, when asked if they would use their new found skills to pay bills and conduct internet banking almost all of them still preferred the security of face to face contact with a real person.

Daniel Follett

Other
MRC Staff Members



LULU TANTOS
Deputy Director
Migration Agent



ARLENE RICHARDS
Financial Controller



MARY MILEVSKI
Office Manager



SINEAD BUCKLEY
Citizenship &
Administration Officer



SHARRNA DUFFY
Administration Officer



ROZ KAPUSTA
Refugee Settlement
Officer (Visa 202)



LOUISE GIBSON
Refugee Settlement
Assistant

Centre Usage 2005

African Community	Korean Group
African Women & Children	Latvian Group
Amnesty International	Migrant Health Unit – Information Sessions
Baha'i Community of Newcastle	Multicultural Dementia Carers Support Group
Bosnian Community of Newcastle	Multicultural Women's Support Group
Burundi Dance Group	Newcastle & Hunter Ethnic Choral Society
Centrelink Multicultural Forum	Newcastle Japanese Akebano Group
Community Options NESB Committee	Refugee & Humanitarian Entrant New Arrivals - Welcome
Community Support for Refugees Group	Right From The Start
DIMIA Immigration Officers Field Visits	Russian Women's Support Group
Esperanto Society	Samoan Women's Group
Estonian Community of Newcastle	School of Filipino Studies
Filipino Community Choir	Skillmax
Filipino Women's Group	Slovene Association of Newcastle
First Aid	South Pacific Islander Culture in Education (SPICE)
Greek Macedonian Brotherhood Pavlos Melas	Sri Lankan Community
Greek Orthodox Holy Apostles	STARRTS Counselling Sessions
Greencard	Sudanese Community of Newcastle
Guardianship	Sudanese Women Dance Group
Hamilton Multicultural Walkers Group	Tamil Language School
Hamilton Olympic Soccer Club	Tongan Community Choir
Homestart	Tongan Women's Group
Huneter Refugee Network	Ukrainian Carers Group
Hunter Community Legal Clinic	United Nations Association
Hunter Ethnic Parents & Teachers Association Of Community Languages	Vietnamese Language School
Interagency on Migrant Issues	Work Directions
International Choir	

“When I become a citizen of Australia
and I can welcome another refugee
from another war
I will not have to ask their story
for I will know the story
and I will feel privileged
to show them the friendship
that I have been shown”

Robert
Ambassador
'Journeys from Africa – Destination Hunter'
Living In Harmony Project
2005

The following pages are dedicated to the

REFUGEE WEEK CELEBRATIONS 2005

held at

Singleton Community Services Centre (CSSS outreach)

Friday 28 October

&

Newcastle Foreshore Park

Saturday 29 October

*Photographs are accompanied by a selection of quotes
by Ambassadors - Living In Harmony Project 2005*

Thank you to all those who attended, participated & celebrated with us!

Africa is the biggest continent in the world.

It has more than 15 countries, with different cultures, different tribes & different religions. Many people from African countries now call the Hunter their 'new home'. On these pages is a selection of comments from some of them.



"I arrived in Sydney in January 2005.
I thought police would arrest me
and I would be made a slave...
but instead I was welcomed by Australians
and a group from the MRC.
I was treated as a friend. I began to shed tears
because for a long time I hadn't felt so welcome"
(Eunyce)



"In our refugee camp in Guinea,
the tents leaked so much in the
rainy season that we had to stand,
holding our children
and our mats"
(Gladys)

"All we knew (about Australia) was
wrong – we would have
to break rocks for a living;
we would be sent to live with
sheep and cows; there were
no churches, no religion..."
(Gladys)



“When I was 7,
the soldiers came to our house
and my sisters and I hid inside.
My older sister went to see
what was happening...
but she didn't come back.
So later,
we all ran into the bushes...
and then out of town...
”
and then to another country

Eunyce
Ambassador
'Journeys from Africa – Destination Hunter'
Living In Harmony Project
2005

Singleton has a long history of caring for refugees starting with refugees from the Kosovo war in 1988. We thought it would be good to hold a celebration here during National Refugee Week.



"There is a new beginning for the mothers and the fathers that have come to Australia but most of all there is a new land of peace for our children. Peace is what we would ask for our children and for their children for we have seen the worst things that can happen from war".

(Robert)

"Australia is such a lovely country to live in. There are lots of freedom, happiness and great security... All refugees living here feel highly blessed. All my life there were disruptions and difficulties but I was happy the day I arrived in Australia"

(Joyce)



"When we reached the Immigration Counter at Sydney Airport, after many, many hours flight, the man said to me "Are you here for a holiday or to stay?" I said to him "To stay."

He said to me "Welcome to your second home" and my family and I felt so happy".

(Makur)

"During the fighting, we all stayed at home all day and at night my husband and I would go out very quietly looking for food - we would run to the shops and run home again...there was no school for the children for 4 years".

(Aisha)





**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF
NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

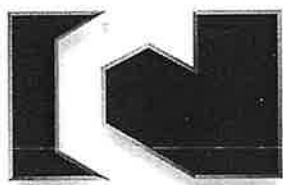
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Financial Report

For The Year Ended 30 June 2005



Cutcher & Neale
CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS



Cutcher & Neale
MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF
NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED

Financial Report
For the Year Ended
30 June 2005

Contents

Directors' Report	1 - 3
Auditors' Independence Declaration	4
Auditors' Report	5 - 6
Directors' Declaration	7
Statement of Financial Performance	8
Statement of Financial Position	9
Statement of Cash Flows	10
Notes to the Financial Statements	11 - 21
Compilation Report	22
Detailed Statement of Financial Performance	23 - 24

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 1

DIRECTORS' REPORT

Your Directors present their report on the Company for the financial year ended 30 June 2005.

The names of the Directors in office at any time during or since the end of the year are:

Name	Position		Years Service
Henry Chan	Chairman	Member of Newcastle and Hunter Valley Chinese Association/Financial Advisor	17
Trudy Mills Evers	Director	Dutch Community Representative	20
William Samanowsky	Director	Ukrainian Community Representative	16
Ivan Klopčič	Director	President of Slovenian Association	9
Alina Kizewater	Director	Representing the Polish Community (Retired as President of Polish Association February 2005)	14
Zoran Vasiljević	Director	Bosnian Community Representative	10
Sania Young	Director	Tartar Community Representative	7
Fr Nicholas Zervas	Director	Greek Community Representative	6
Paul Mather	Director	Fellow of the Institute of Chartered Accountants (deceased November 2004)	4
Phillip Ross	Director	Newcastle Police Citizens Youth Club (appointed April 2005)	1
Andrea Rufo	Director	Italian Community Representative	2
<i>Co-opted Members</i>			
Barbara Gaudry	Director	Newcastle Council Representative	1
Tim Morgan	Director	DIMIA Consultant (appointed September 2004)	1
Deborah Carr	Director	DIMIA Consultant (resigned August 2004)	10

Directors have been in office since the start of the financial year to the date of this report unless otherwise stated.

Principal Activities

The principal activity of the Company is the provision of welfare and information services.

There were no significant changes in the nature of these activities during the financial year.

Operating Results

The net result of operations from ordinary activities for the year ended 30 June 2005 was a profit of \$35,219.

Review of Operations

Operating profit of \$35,219 compares with a profit of \$43,161 achieved in 2004.

The Company operated successfully throughout the period applying grant funds for the purposes for which they were provided. All obligations and conditions of funding have been met.

Significant Changes in State of Affairs

In the opinion of the Directors, there has been no significant change in the state of affairs of the Company for the financial year.

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 2

DIRECTORS' REPORT

After Balance Date Events

No matters or circumstances have arisen since the end of the financial year which significantly affected or may significantly affect the operations of the Company, the results of those operations, or the state of affairs of the Company in future financial years.

Future Developments

No information is included on the likely developments in the operations of the Company and the expected results of those operations.

Environmental Issues

The Company's operations are subject to environmental regulation under the law of the Commonwealth and State. The Directors are not aware of any breaches of the legislation during the financial year which are material in nature.

Meeting of Directors

During the financial period, 12 meetings of Directors were held. Attendances were:

	No. Available	No. Attended
Henry Chan	12	10
Trudy Mills Evers	12	10
William Samanowsky	12	11
Ivan Klopce	12	9
Alina Kizewater	12	9
Zoran Vailisjevic	12	8
Sania Young	12	11
Fr Nicholas Zervas	12	10
Paul Mather (deceased November 2004)	3	3
Andrea Rufo	12	1
Barbara Gaudry	12	6
Phillip Ross (appointed April 2005)	2	1
Tim Morgan (appointed September 2004)	8	0
Deborah Carr (resigned august 2004)	1	0

Auditor's Independence Declaration

The lead auditor's independence declaration for the year ended 30 June 2005 has been received and can be found on page 4 of the financial report.

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 3

DIRECTORS' REPORT

Indemnifying Officers or Auditor

Clause 83 of the Company's Articles of Association states:-

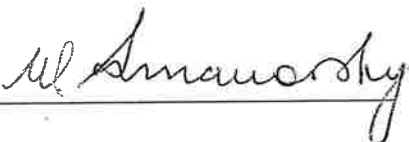
"Every member of the Management Committee, secretary and other office for the time being of the Centre shall be indemnified out of the assets of the Centre against any liability arising out of the execution of the duties of his or her office which is incurred by him or her defending any proceedings, whether civil or criminal, in which judgement is given under the Code in which relief is granted to him or her by the Court in respect of any negligence, default, breach of duty or breach of trust".

Directors' Emoluments

No Director has received or become entitled to receive, during or since the financial year, a benefit because of a contract made by the Company, with a Director, a firm of which a Director is a Member or an entity in which a Director has a substantial financial interest. This statement excludes a benefit included in the aggregate amount of emoluments received or due and receivable by Directors and shown in the Company's accounts.

Signed in accordance with a resolution of the Board of Directors:


Director


Director

Dated this 22nd day of Nov 2005

**AUDITORS INDEPENDENCE DECLARATION
UNDER SECTION 307C OF THE CORPORATIONS ACT 2001
TO THE DIRECTORS OF
MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

I declare that to the best of my knowledge and belief, during the year ended 30 June 2005 there have been:

- (i) No contraventions of the auditor independence requirements as set out in the Corporations Act 2001 in relation to the audit; and
- (ii) no contravention of any applicable code of professional conduct in relation to the audit.

Dated this 12 day of October 2005
First Floor
25 Bolton Street
NEWCASTLE


CUTCHER & NEALE
CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS
M. J. O'Connor CA
Partner

**INDEPENDENT AUDIT REPORT
TO THE MEMBERS OF
MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

Scope

The financial report comprises the statement of financial position, statement of financial performance, statement of cashflows, accompanying notes to the financial statements, and the Directors' declaration for Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited, for the year ended 30 June 2005.

The Directors of the company are responsible for the preparation and true and fair presentation of the financial report in accordance with the Corporations Act 2001. This includes responsibility for the maintenance of adequate accounting records and internal controls that are designed to prevent and detect fraud and error, and for the accounting policies and accounting estimates inherent in the financial report.

Audit approach

We conducted an independent audit in order to express an opinion to the Members. Our audit was conducted in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards, in order to provide reasonable assurance as to whether the financial report is free of material misstatement. The nature of an audit is influenced by factors such as the use of professional judgment, selective testing, the inherent limitations of internal control, and the availability of persuasive rather than conclusive evidence. Therefore, an audit cannot guarantee that all material misstatements have been detected.

We performed procedures to assess whether in all material respects the financial report is presented fairly in accordance with the Corporations Act 2001, including compliance with Accounting Standards and other mandatory financial reporting requirements in Australia, a view which is consistent with our understanding of the company's financial position, and of its performance as represented by the results of its operations and cash flows.

We formed our audit opinion on the basis of these procedures, which included:

- (a) examining, on a test basis, information to provide evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial report; and
- (b) assessing the reasonableness of the accounting policies and disclosures used and the reasonableness of significant accounting estimates made by the Directors.

While we considered the effectiveness of management's internal controls over financial reporting when determining the nature and extent of our procedures, our audit was not designed to provide assurance on internal controls.

Independence

In conducting our audit, we followed applicable independence requirements of Australian professional ethical pronouncements and the Corporations Act 2001.

**INDEPENDENT AUDIT REPORT
TO THE MEMBERS OF
MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

Qualification

The Company departs from Accounting Standards AASB 1021 for the reason raised in Note 1. The financial effect for the year ended 30 June 2005 of the above departures is an understatement of operating surplus of \$62,695 and an overstatement of the asset revaluation reserve of \$62,695.

Qualified Audit Opinion

In our opinion, except for the effects of the matter referred to above, the financial report of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter region Limited is in accordance with:

a. the Corporations Act 2001, including:

- i. giving a true and fair view of the company's financial position as at 30 June 2005 and of their performance for the year ended on that date; and
- ii. complying with Accounting Standards in Australia and the Corporations Regulations 2001;

b. other mandatory financial reporting requirements in Australia

Dated this 13 day of October 2005
First Floor
25 Bolton Street
NEWCASTLE


CUTCHER & NEALE
CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS

M. J. O'Connor CA
Partner

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 7

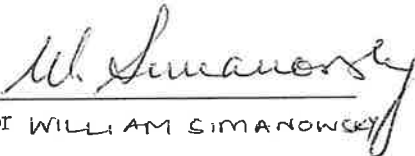
DIRECTORS' DECLARATION

The Directors of the Company declare that:

1. the financial statements and notes, as set out on pages 8 to 21 are in accordance with the Corporations Act 2001:
 - (a) comply with Accounting Standards in Australia and the Corporations Regulations 2001; and
 - (b) give a true and fair view of the financial position as at 30 June 2005 and of the performance for the year ended on that date of the Company
2. in the Directors' opinion, there are reasonable grounds to believe that the Company will be able to pay its debts as and when they become due and payable.

This declaration is made in accordance with a resolution of the Board of Directors.


Director PHILLIP ROSS


Director WILLIAM SIMANOVSKY

Dated this 7th day of OCT 2005.

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 8

**STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

	Note	2005 \$	2004 \$
Revenues from ordinary activities	2	690,217	571,368
Employee benefits expense		(259,732)	(228,149)
Depreciation and amortisation expense	3	(15,369)	(21,155)
Administration expenses		(184,599)	(158,230)
Other expenses from ordinary activities	3	(195,298)	(120,673)
Profit/(loss) from ordinary activities		<u>35,219</u>	<u>43,161</u>
Valuation adjustments recognised Directly against equity	18	62,695	-
Total change in equity		<u>97,914</u>	<u>43,161</u>

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 9

**STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION
AS AT 30 JUNE 2005**

	Note	2005 \$	2004 \$
CURRENT ASSETS			
Cash assets	5	377,020	355,200
Receivables	6	129,242	116,873
Other	7	6,809	10,415
TOTAL CURRENT ASSETS		<u>513,071</u>	<u>482,488</u>
NON CURRENT ASSETS			
Plant & equipment	8	111,935	70,239
TOTAL NON CURRENT ASSETS		<u>111,935</u>	<u>70,239</u>
TOTAL ASSETS		<u>625,006</u>	<u>552,727</u>
CURRENT LIABILITIES			
Payables	9	33,970	83,797
Provisions	10	172,249	137,245
TOTAL CURRENT LIABILITIES		<u>206,219</u>	<u>221,042</u>
NON CURRENT LIABILITIES			
Provisions	10	11,256	22,068
TOTAL NON CURRENT LIABILITIES		<u>11,256</u>	<u>22,068</u>
TOTAL LIABILITIES		<u>217,475</u>	<u>243,110</u>
NET ASSETS		<u>407,531</u>	<u>309,617</u>
EQUITY			
Retained profits	11	344,836	285,617
Asset revaluation reserve	18	62,695	24,000
TOTAL EQUITY		<u>407,531</u>	<u>309,617</u>

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 10

**STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

	Note	2005 \$	2004 \$
CASH FLOW FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES			
Receipts from customers		619,749	549,080
Payments to creditors and employees		(549,439)	(501,601)
Interest received		13,425	9,878
Net cash provided by (used in) operating activities	18(b)	83,735	57,357
CASH FLOW FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES			
Purchase of plant & equipment		(70,551)	(25,387)
Proceeds from sale of plant & equipment		8,636	12,000
Net cash provided by (used in) investing activities		(61,915)	(13,387)
Net decrease in cash held		21,820	43,970
Cash at 1 July 2004		355,200	311,230
Cash at 30 June 2005	18(a)	377,020	355,200

The accompanying notes form part of these financial statements

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 11

**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

NOTE 1 STATEMENT OF SIGNIFICANT ACCOUNTING POLICIES

The financial report is a general purpose financial report that has been prepared in accordance with Accounting Standards, Urgent Issues Group Consensus Views, other authoritative pronouncements of the Australian Accounting Standards Board and the Corporations Act 2001.

The financial report has also been prepared on an accruals basis and is based on historical costs and does not take into account changing money values or, except where stated, current valuations of non-current assets. Cost is based on the fair values of the consideration given in exchange for assets.

The following is a summary of the material accounting policies adopted by the Company in the preparation of the financial report. The accounting policies have been consistently applied, unless otherwise stated.

(a) Income Tax

The Company is exempt from income tax under Section 50-30 of the Income Tax Assessment Act 1997.

(b) Plant & Equipment

Each class of plant and equipment is carried at cost less, where applicable, any accumulated depreciation.

Plant and Equipment

Plant and equipment are measured on the cost basis.

The carrying amount of plant and equipment is reviewed annually by the Directors to ensure it is not in excess of the recoverable amount from these assets. The recoverable amount is assessed on the basis of the expected net cash flows which will be received from the assets employment and subsequent disposal. The expected net cash flows have not been discounted to their present values in determining recoverable amounts.

Depreciation

The depreciable amount of all fixed assets are depreciated over their estimated useful lives to the Company commencing from the time the asset is held ready for use. Leasehold improvements are depreciated over the estimated useful lives of the improvements.

In accordance with grant funding requirements the assets of the Company are written off as acquired and then restated at written down value in the accounts of the Company at year end through the Asset Revaluation Reserve.

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 12

**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

NOTE 1 STATEMENT OF SIGNIFICANT ACCOUNTING POLICIES (cont'd)

The depreciation rates used for each class of depreciable assets are:

Class of Asset	Average Depreciation rate
Leasehold improvements	14.3 to 20% PC
Equipment	10% to 40% DV
Motor vehicles	22.5%PC

(c) Employee Entitlements

Provision is made for the Company's liability for employee entitlements arising from services rendered by employees to balance date. Employee entitlements expected to be settled within one year together with entitlements arising from wages and salaries and annual leave which will be settled after one year, have been measured at their nominal amount. Other employee entitlements payable later than one year have been measured at the nominal value.

Employee entitlements are calculated for each employee from the first day of employment, so that an accurate charge can be allocated to each grant.

Contributions are made by the Company to employee superannuation funds and are charged as expenses when incurred.

(d) Cash

For the purpose of the statement of cashflows, cash includes:

- cash on hand and at call deposits with banks or financial institutions, net of bank overdrafts; and
- investments in money market instruments maturing with less than 14 days to maturity.

(e) Revenue

Revenue from the rendering of a service is recognised upon the delivery of the service to the customers.

Interest revenue is recognised on a proportional basis taking into account the interest rates applicable to the financial assets.

All revenue is stated net of the amount of goods and services tax (GST).

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 13

**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

NOTE 1 STATEMENT OF SIGNIFICANT ACCOUNTING POLICIES (cont'd)

(f) Goods and Services Tax (GST)

Revenues, expenses and assets are recognised net of the amount of GST, except where the amount of GST incurred is not recoverable from the Australian Tax Office. In these circumstances the GST is recognised as part of the cost of acquisition of the asset or as part of an item of the expense. Receivables and payables in the statement of financial position are shown inclusive of GST.

(g) Comparative Figures

Where required by Accounting Standards comparative figures have been adjusted to conform with changes in presentation for the current financial year.

(h) Administration Fees

Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited charge each grant as set out in Note 1 (i), an administration fee at commercial rates. Where the grant is unable to remit payment to Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited this amount is shown as a bad debt or provision for doubtful debts where applicable.

(i) Affiliated Grant Activities

Affiliated grant activities of the Company have been excluded from the financial report. These activities are:

- Community Visitors Scheme
- Family Support
- Filipino Welfare Project
- Community Settlement Service Scheme I
- Community Settlement Service Scheme II
- Community Settlement Services Scheme New England
- Sudanese and Other African Humanitarian Entrants CSS Project
- Immigration Advice and Application Assistance Scheme
- Community Aged Care Packages
- Refugee Housing
- Families First Cald Worker
- Hunter Sudanese Support Project
- Central Coast Cald, Social Support Services Project
- Respite Care

(j) Grant Contribution

Amounts received from affiliated grants that are unable to pay the allocated administration charge and long service leave contribution at balance date are written off. This amount is raised as a grant contribution in Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter region Limited.

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 14

**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

NOTE 1 STATEMENT OF SIGNIFICANT ACCOUNTING POLICIES (cont'd)

(k) Unexpended Grant Monies

The unexpended grant monies (Note 9) shown in the accounts will be brought to account over the term of the contracts or repaid to the funding body as set out in the funding agreements.

(l) Change to Accounting Policy

The assets of the Company are written off as acquired and then restated at written down value in the accounts of the Company at year end through the Asset Revaluation Reserve. This treatment is contrary to Accounting Standard AASB 1021:Depreciation. This results in profit being understated by \$62,695 and the Asset Revaluation Reserve being overstated by \$62,695. (Cost \$70,551 less notional depreciation \$7,856).

(m) Adoption of Australian Equivalents to International Financial Reporting Standards

Australia is currently preparing for the introduction of International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS) effective for financial years commencing 1 January 2005. This requires the production of accounting data for future comparative purposes at the beginning of the next financial year.

The directors are of the opinion that the key differences in the organisation's accounting policies which will arise from the adoption of IFRS are:

Impairment of Assets

The organisation currently determines the recoverable amount of an asset on the basis of undiscounted net cash flows that will be received from the assets use and subsequent disposal. Under AASB 136: Impairment of Assets, the recoverable amount of an asset will be determined as the higher of the net disposal value and value in use. Value in use is determined by the present value of the future cash flows it is expected to generate. There have been no changes to the accounts for the year ending 30 June 2005.

NOTE 2 REVENUE

Operating activities

	2005	2004
	\$	\$
- Grant funds	319,277	289,175
- Administration fee received	291,378	254,435
- Interest received – other persons	13,425	9,878
- Contribution from grants – motor vehicles	24,000	-
- Other revenue	33,501	5,880
Total Revenue	681,581	559,368

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 15

**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

	2005 \$	2004 \$
NOTE 2 REVENUE (cont'd)		
Non-Operating activities		
- Proceeds on disposal of plant & equipment	8,636	12,000
	<u>690,217</u>	<u>571,368</u>

NOTE 3 PROFIT FROM ORDINARY ACTIVITIES

Profit from ordinary activities has been determined after:

(a) Expenses

Depreciation of non current assets
- plant and equipment

	13,779	18,487
--	--------	--------

Amortisation of non current asset
- leasehold improvements

	1,590	2,668
--	-------	-------

Remuneration of auditor
- audit

	5,359	5,766
--	-------	-------

Rental expense on operating lease
- minimum lease payments

	76,132	72,428
--	--------	--------

Motor vehicle purchases

1 (I)

	70,551	-
--	--------	---

Bad and doubtful debts
- grant debtors

	30,060	30,177
--	--------	--------

Administration cost

	13,196	12,302
--	--------	--------

	<u>195,298</u>	<u>120,673</u>
--	----------------	----------------

(a) Revenue and Net Gains

Net (profit)/loss on disposal of plant and equipment

	(2,781)	302
--	---------	-----

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 16

**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

	2005	2004
	\$	\$

NOTE 4 DIRECTORS' REMUNERATION

(a) Directors Remuneration

Income paid or payable to all Directors of the Company

- -

Number of Company Directors whose income from the Company was within the following band:

\$0 - \$9,999

- -

The names of Directors who have held office during the financial year are:

Henry Chan	Trudy Mills Evers
William Samanowsky	Ivan Klopac
Alina Kizewater	Zoran Valisjevic
Sanja Young	Barbara Gaudry
Fr Nicholas Zervas	Andrea Rufo
Paul Mather	Phillip Ross
Tim Morgan	

NOTE 5 CASH

Cash at bank	222,644	189,825
Deposits at call	154,376	165,375
	377,020	355,200

NOTE 6 RECEIVABLES

Trade debtors	88,869	73,409
Provision for loss on administration fees	(29,192)	(11,236)
	59,677	62,173
Other debtors	69,565	54,700
	129,242	116,873

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 17

**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

	2005 \$	2004 \$
NOTE 7 OTHER ASSETS		
Prepayments	6,809	10,415
NOTE 8 PLANT & EQUIPMENT		
Leasehold improvements – at cost	36,532	36,532
Less: accumulated amortisation	(34,728)	(33,138)
	1,804	3,394
Equipment – at cost	109,580	122,219
Less: accumulated depreciation	(96,617)	(104,128)
	12,963	18,091
Motor vehicles – at cost	116,802	65,663
Less: accumulated depreciation	(19,634)	(16,909)
	97,168	48,754
Total Plant & Equipment	111,935	70,239

Movements in carrying amounts

Movements in the carrying amount for each class of plant and equipment between the beginning and the end of the current financial year.

	Leasehold Improvements	Equipment	Motor Vehicles	Total
Balance at the beginning of the year	3,394	18,091	48,754	70,239
Additions	-	-	70,551	70,551
Disposals	-	(411)	(5,219)	(5,630)
Depreciation and amortisation expense	(1,590)	(4,717)	(9,062)	(15,369)
Movements to Asset Revaluation Reserve	-	-	(7,856)	(7,856)
Carrying amount at the end of the year	1,804	12,963	97,168	111,935

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 18

**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

	2005	2004
	\$	\$
NOTE 9 PAYABLES		
Trade creditors	25,125	38,909
Grant Funds Carried Forward	8,845	44,888
	33,970	83,797
NOTE 10 PROVISIONS		
CURRENT		
Employee entitlements	172,249	137,245
NON CURRENT		
Employee entitlements	11,256	22,068
(a) Aggregate employee entitlement liability	183,505	159,313
(b) Number of employees at year end	29	20
NOTE 11 RETAINED PROFITS		
Retained profits at the beginning of the financial year	309,617	266,456
Net profit/(loss) attributable to members of the Company	35,219	43,161
Retained profits at the end of the financial year	344,836	309,617

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 19

**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

	2005	2004
	\$	\$

NOTE 12 COMPANY DETAILS

The registered office and principal place of business is:

8 Chaucer Street
HAMILTON NSW 2303

NOTE 13 CAPITAL & LEASING COMMITMENTS

(a) Operating Lease Commitments

Non-cancellable operating leases contracted
for but not capitalised in the financial report

Payable

- not longer than 1 year	78,500	63,097
- longer than 1 year but not longer than 5 years	137,375	-
	215,875	63,097

The property lease is a non-cancellable lease with a three-year term, with rent payable monthly in advance. Contingent rental provisions within the lease agreement require the minimum lease payments shall be increased by CPI. An option exists to renew the lease at the end of the three-year term for an additional term of three years.

NOTE 14 MEMBERS' GUARANTEE

The Company is limited by guarantee. If the Company is wound up, the articles of the Company state that each Member is required to contribute a maximum of \$10 each towards meeting any outstanding obligations of the Company. At 30 June 2005 the number of Members was 55 (2004 - 69)

NOTE 15 SEGMENT REPORTING

The Company operates in the services industry wholly within Australia.

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 20

**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

NOTE 16 FINANCIAL INSTRUMENT

(a) Interest Rate Risk

The financial assets and liabilities subject to interest rate risk are:

Bank Accounts

The Company's bank accounts earn interest at the market variable rate.

Short Term Deposits

The Company's term deposit earns interest at a rate of 5.75%.

All other financial assets and financial liabilities are not subject to interest rate risk as they are non-interest bearing.

(b) Credit Risk

The credit risk on financial assets of the Company which have been recognised on the balance sheet, is the carrying amount net of any provision for doubtful debts.

(c) Net Fair Value of Financial Assets and Liabilities

The Company's financial assets and liabilities included in the balance sheet are carried at amounts that approximate net fair value.

2005	2004
\$	\$

NOTE 17 STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS

(a) Reconciliation of Cash

Cash at the end of the financial year as shown in the statement of cashflows is reconciled to the related items in the statement of financial position as follows:

Cash at bank	222,644	189,825
Cash on deposit	154,376	165,375
	377,020	355,200

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 21

**NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

	2005 \$	2004 \$
NOTE 17 STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS (cont'd)		
(b) Reconciliation of cash flow from operations with profit from ordinary activities		
Profit/(loss) from ordinary activities	35,219	43,161
Non-cash flows in profit from ordinary activities:		
Depreciation and amortisation	15,369	21,155
(Profit) / Loss on sale of fixed assets	(2,781)	302
Equipment expensed reported as investing activity	70,551	-
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
(Increase) / decrease in receivables	(12,369)	(40,252)
(Increase) / decrease in prepayments	3,606	(944)
Increase / (decrease) in trade creditors and accruals	(14,009)	16,577
Increase / (decrease) in provisions	24,192	(10,484)
Increase / (decrease) in grant funds carried forward	(36,043)	27,842
Cash flow from operations	83,735	57,357

NOTE 18 RESERVES

Asset revaluation reserve		
Opening balance	-	-
Cost of Plant & Equipment previously expensed	70,551	-
Depreciation of Revalued plant & equipment	(7,856)	-
	62,695	-
Closing balance	62,695	-

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED**

ABN 72 002 898 759

(A Company Limited by Guarantee and having no Share Capital)

Page 22

**COMPILATION REPORT
TO MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE
AND HUNTER REGION LIMITED**

Scope

On the basis of information provided by the Directors of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited, we have compiled in accordance with APS 9 'Statement on Compilation of Financial Reports' the following;

- 1) Detailed Statement of Financial Performance

of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited for the period ended 30 June 2005.

The specific purpose for which the above detailed financial reports have been prepared is to provide private information to the Directors and Members. Accounting Standards and UIG Consensus Views have been adopted in the preparation of the above detailed financial reports.

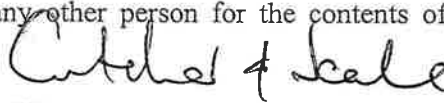
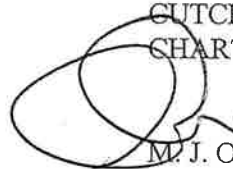
The Directors are solely responsible for the information contained in the above detailed financial reports and have determined that the accounting policies used are consistent with the financial reporting requirements of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited constitution and are appropriate to meet the needs of the Directors and Members of the Company.

Our procedures use accounting expertise to collect, classify and summarise the financial information, which the Directors have provided into the detailed financial reports. Our statutory audit procedures do not include verification or validation procedures over allocations within the above detailed financial reports and accordingly no assurance or opinion is expressed as to their accuracy.

To the extent permitted by law, we do not accept liability for any loss or damage which any person, other than the Company, may suffer arising from any negligence on our part. No person should rely on the above detailed financial reports without having an audit or review conducted upon them.

The above detailed financial reports were prepared for the benefit of the Directors and Members of Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and Hunter Region Limited and the purpose identified above. We do not accept responsibility to any other person for the contents of the special purpose financial report.

1st Floor
25 Bolton Street
NEWCASTLE


CUTCHER & NEALE
CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS

M. J. O'Connor
Partner
28 September 2005

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED (A COMPANY LIMITED BY GUARANTEE)
ABN 72 002 898 759**

Page 23

**STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

	2005	2004
<u>Income</u>		
Administration Fees	291,378	254,435
Donations received	6,984	127
Grants received	319,277	317,017
Transfer from unexpended funds	-	17,046
Less Carried forward to next year	-	(44,888)
Interest received	13,425	9,878
Interpreting fee	-	136
Membership Fees	160	76
MS direct migration	109	202
Photocopying	291	635
Contribution to expenses	26,077	2,935
Skillmax program	4,545	-
Sundry	19,335	1,769
Total Income	681,581	559,368

<u>Expenses</u>		
Administration fees	-	-
Advertising	1,371	2,484
Audit and accounting fees	5,359	5,766
Bank charges	176	543
Carer week expenses	-	4,016
Catering, function	3,429	4,220
Cleaning	9,139	7,518
Computer expenses	12,541	11,525
Depreciation and amortisation	15,369	21,155
Donations	789	200
Electricity	5,846	5,481
Fringe benefits tax	1,323	1,211
Grant Contribution	12,103	39,806
Insurance	8,394	8,693
Program Costs	3,708	-
Interpreting fees	504	1,185
Library	290	-
Licence fees	3,960	548
Loss on sale	-	302
Motor Vehicle	70,551	
Photocopier expenses	12,195	9,570

**MIGRANT RESOURCE CENTRE OF NEWCASTLE AND HUNTER REGION
LIMITED (A COMPANY LIMITED BY GUARANTEE)
ABN 72 002 898 759**

Page 24

**STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE
FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2005**

	2005	2004
Office furniture	8,850	3,816
Office supplies	5,639	1,229
Postage	8,722	8,576
Printing and Stationery	6,712	8,481
Provision for loss on administration fees	17,956	(9,629)
Refugee Week	1,049	-
Rent	76,132	72,428
Rent outgoings	20,336	16,308
Repairs and Maintenance	2,409	1,322
Security	919	835
Seminar and training	164	2,878
Staff amenities	6,744	4,862
Subscriptions and membership	315	530
Telephone	35,892	33,074
Travel	1,748	2,033
Wages	259,732	228,149
Workers Compensation	25,996	17,092
Total Expenses	<u>646,362</u>	<u>516,207</u>
Operating profit/(loss)	<u>35,219</u>	<u>43,161</u>